

Unit 1

Lesson 1

Words from Proper Names

1. **Jingoist:** One who boasts about his patriotism and favors a warlike foreign policy. In 1877, British Prime Minister Disraeli sent the fleet to Gallipoli to slow up the Russians. A singer wrote a ditty called “By Jingo” in honor of that action.
2. **Lothario:** rake; seducer; lover. Lothario was an amorous character in an eighteenth-century play. *The Fair Penitent*.
3. **Maverick:** one who acts independently. Samuel Maverick was a Texas rancher who refused to brand his cattle as others were doing.
4. **Nemesis:** Agent of retribution; just punishment. In Greek mythology, the goddess Nemesis punished pretentiousness with her swords and avenging wings.
5. **Philanderer:** one who makes love insincerely; one who engages in passing love affairs. The word comes from the Greek philandros (“man loving”) but gained its current usage because many English playwrights gave the name to their romantic leads.
6. **Philippic:** Bitter verbal attack. Philip II of Macedon wanted to make Greece into a monarchy. He was opposed by the great orator, Demosthenes, who denounced Philip in devastating speeches that came to be known as philippics.
7. **Procrustean:** designed to secure conformity; drastic. An ancient Greek robber named Procrustes tied his victims to a bed and then, to make them fit the bed, stretched the short ones and hacked off the limbs of the taller ones.
8. **Protean:** changeable; taking on different forms. In Greek mythology, Proteus was a sea god who could change his appearance at will.
9. **Pyrrhic victory:** a victory that is exceptionally costly. Pyrrhus defeated the Romans in 279 B.C. but his losses were terribly heavy.
10. **Quixotic:** romantically idealistic; impractical. The Spanish novelist, Cervantes, brought this word into our language when he wrote *Don Quixote*. His hero went forth foolishly to tilt against windmills and help the downtrodden.
11. **Saturnine:** sluggish; gloomy; grave. The planet Saturn is so far from the sun that it was thought to be cold and dismal.

12. **Solecism**: substandard use of words; violation of good manners. This word derives from the Greek inhabitants of the colony of Soloi who used a slangy dialect.
13. **Spoonerism**: an unintentional exchange of sounds. Reverend Spooner of New College, Oxford occasionally twisted his words around when he got excited so that “conquering kings: came out as “kinkering congs”
14. **Sybarite**: one who is fond of luxury and soft living. Sybaris was a fabulously wealthy Italian city, symbolic of the good life.
15. **Tawdry**: cheap; gaudy; showy. This word can be traced to St. Audrey. Scarves called “St. Audrey’s laces” were sold in England where the local people changed the pronunciation to tawdry. The quality of the scarves, which at first was good, deteriorated, when they were mass produced for the peasant trade.

Exercises:

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. You want to rip into your neighbor for his bigoted remarks.
(philanderer, philippic, protean)
2. A newspaper editorial calls for us to send the fleet to intimidate a Caribbean country.
(jingoism, spoonerism, solecism)
3. All the girls wear pantsuits except Betsy who prefers dresses
(maverick, saturnine, nemesis)
4. I heard of a scheme that would provide \$10,000 for each American family.
(lothario, Pyrrhic victory, quixotic)
5. Everyone at the meeting was forced to change his or her mind in order to agree with the chairman’s philosophy.
(tawdry, sybarite, procrustean)
6. It’s unusual for a fashion editor to have such a gawdy taste in jewelry.

(tawdry, saturnine, protean)

7. Mark boasted of having been engaged seven times.

(philippic, lothario, jingoist)

8. The singer was fond of saying he always did it his way.

(maverick, solecism, spoonerism)

9. Rudy likes caviar and imported champagne.

(sybarite, nemesis, philanderer)

10. The senator blasted his opponent in a fiery speech.

(quixotic, procrustean, philippic)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. No one welcomes a Pyrrhic victory.

____ 2. A jingoist is a hawk rather than a dove.

____ 3. "I don't know nothing" is a spoonerism.

____ 4. A nemesis is something like a jinx.

____ 5. Going along with the majority is a maverick's way.

____ 6. A tawdry garment is tasteful.

____ 7. By Ed's saturnine expression, we knew that the news was bad.

____ 8. The prison diet of bread and water was in keeping with the sybarite's lifestyle.

____ 9. The class was shocked at the professor's use of a solecism.

____ 10. Placing a man on the moon was once considered a quixotic idea.

III. Fill in Blank.

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. My cousin tried to diet, but desserts proved to be his _____.
2. Charley, a born _____, always votes against the majority.
3. The usually level-headed Kyra came up with a _____ suggestion that was totally out of character.
4. Andrea thought she looked elegant, but we found her appearance to be _____.
5. At the end of a one-hour _____ against taxes, the candidate received thunderous applause.
6. The _____ had contempt for anyone he thought lacked patriotic spirit.
7. After my tongue-tied _____, I apologized to our hostess and left.
8. With fifty servants to wait on him, the Roman emperor was a true _____.
9. Considering himself a _____, Uncle Don proposed to every widow in town.
10. Myrtle's _____ expression was the result of a chronic stomach condition.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. Conformist _____
2. Eulogy _____
3. Tasteful _____
4. Lively _____
5. Practical _____
6. Constant _____
7. Faithful husband _____
8. Conservative _____
9. Political Dove _____
10. Democratic _____

Lesson 2

Appearances and Attitudes

1. **Acidulous**: somewhat acid or sour
2. **Baleful**: deadly; sinister.
3. **Bellicose**: warlike; of a quarrelsome nature
4. **Bilious**: bad-tempered; bitter. It comes from the French word bilis (“bile”), the fluid secreted by the liver
5. **Bumptious**: arrogant; disagreeably conceited.
6. **Captious**: critical; quick to find fault; quibbling.
7. **Churlish**: boorish; surly. This adjective comes from “churl,” the old word for a peasant.
8. **Complaisant**: willing to please; tending to consent to others’ wishes.
9. **Contrite**: crushed in spirit by a feeling of guilt.
10. **Convivial**: festive; sociable.
11. **Craven**: cowardly
12. **Debonair**: courteous, gracious and having a sophisticated charm; suave; urbane. In Old French the words were de bon aire (“of a good race or breed”)
13. **Dyspeptic**: grouchy; gloomy; a person who suffers from dyspepsia or indigestion.
14. **Lachrymose**: sad; mournful; inclined to shed many tears.
15. **Neurasthenic**: having emotional conflicts that lead to weakness and depression.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. A defendant’s attitude that impresses the jury (debonair, contrite, acidulous)
2. An ill-tempered waiter (complaisant, craven, churlish)
3. Physical ailments that stem from worry (baleful, neurasthenic, bumptious)
4. A person suffering from indigestion (dyspeptic, bellicose, captious)
5. An angry boss insulting his workers (lachrymose, bilious, convivial)

6. Someone with a chip on his or her shoulder (bellicose, craven, complaisant)
7. A tearful movie (captious, lachrymose, churlish)
8. Stealing from the blind man (bumptious, craven, dyspeptic)
9. After the prank, the college boys apologize (contrite, convivial, bilious)
10. Giving someone a hotfoot as a practical joke (churlish, debonair, acidulous)

II. True or False?

In the spaces provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ___ 1. A *craven* leader inspires respect in his followers.
- ___ 2. Citizens are pleased to see a criminal who is *contrite*.
- ___ 3. *Captious* people often split hairs.
- ___ 4. It's difficult for a gawky 14-year-old to look *debonair*.
- ___ 5. By displaying proper etiquette, one can expect to be praised for one's *churlishness*.
- ___ 6. The children's *lachrymose* behavior at the funeral was understandable.
- ___ 7. Arthur's *bumptious* remarks at the dinner embarrassed his roommate.
- ___ 8. We always maintained a *bellicose* relationship with our good neighbor, Canada.
- ___ 9. The *acidulous* reviews led the producers to close the play after two performances.
- ___ 10. The tone at most New Years parties is quite *convivial*.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. The entire audience was sobbing as the curtain came down on the _____ ending.
2. Some patriots labeled the refusal to join the army as a _____ action.
3. I hate dining with _____ people who criticize everything the chef prepares.
4. Our normally peaceful terrier turns _____ whenever the letter carrier arrives.
5. The choral singing and the beautiful decorations lent a _____ flavor to our party.
6. Mel was told that a psychiatrist might cure his _____ symptoms.
7. Benjy's _____ attitude endeared him to his teammates.
8. At game time, the nervous coach displayed a _____ demeanor.
9. Rocco's _____ glare intimidated me.
10. I like to tease _____ characters who are swollen by their imagined importance.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly *opposite* in meaning to the one provided?

1. peaceful _____
2. happy _____
3. congenial _____
4. contrary _____
5. polite _____
6. sweet-tempered _____
7. humble _____
8. well-mannered _____
9. heroic _____
10. well-adjusted _____

Lesson 3

Words About Groups

1. **cabal** – a clique; a small group joined in a secret intrigue; a conspiracy. This French word was formed from the initials of Charles II's ministers (Clifford, Arlington, Buckingham, Ashley, Lauderdale); *cabal* ultimately derives from the Hebrew word *qabbalah*, which referred to a mystical interpretation of the Scripture.
2. **camaraderie** – comradeship; good fellowship. Two soldiers sharing the same room (in German, *kammer*) usually developed a loyal and warm friendship. The Communist Party adopted the word comrade to denote a fellow member.
3. **caste** – a distinct social class or system. Hindu society is traditionally divided into four major hereditary castes, each class separated from the others by restrictions in marriage and occupation.
4. **cortege** – a group of attendants accompanying a person; a ceremonial procession. It is not surprising that cortege is related to court, a place where followers and ceremonies abound.
5. **detente** – a relaxing or easing, especially of international tension. After the Cold War years following World War II, the U.S. embarked on a policy of closer ties with Russia; hence was born the policy of détente.
6. **echelon** – a level of command or authority or rank; a steplike formation of ships, troops, or planes. Coming to English through several languages, the word echelon has descended a ladder starting with the Latin word *scale*, which indeed means ladder, and explains why we still “scale a ladder”
7. **ecumenical** – universal; general; fostering Christian unity throughout the world. The idea of ecumenism, as well as the spirit of brotherhood, was fostered by the far-reaching policies of Pope John XXIII
8. **elite** – the best or most skilled members of a given social group. The word is related to elect and suggest that some people are born with “a silver spoon in their mouth” or at least, are entitled to special privileges. Elite is also used as an adjective.
9. **esprit de corps** – a sense of union and of common interests and responsibilities. The French expression literally means “spirit of feeling as one body.” It implies not only a camaraderie but a sense of pride or honor shared by those involved in an undertaking.
10. **freemasonry** – secret or tacit brotherhood; instinctive sympathy. The Freemasons is an international fraternity for the promotion of brotherly love among its members, as well as a mutual assistance. It began in the Middle Ages as a class of skilled

stoneworkers who possessed secret signs and passwords, a ritual that is still preserved today.

11. **genealogy** – lineage; science of family descent. Though our hereditary character is transmitted through genes in our chromosomes, that does not assure us that our genealogy has provided us with the most desirable traits. Much can and does happen as the generations pass.
12. **hierarchy** – a group of persons or things arranged in order, rank, or grade; a system of church government by clergymen in graded ranks. The Greek word hierarkhes meant “high priest.” From there it was a small step to the designation of the entire church leadership as a hierarchy. With the loss of temporal power by the church after the Middle Ages, the word now refers to any arrangement by authority or position.
13. **hobnob** – to associate on very friendly terms. The title of the novel *To Have and Have Not* is an exact translation of the original meaning of hobnob. This word was formed by a combination of the Old English words habban (to have) and navban (not to have). The modern meaning suggests the egalitarian idea of friendship not based on one’s possessions.
14. **liaison** – the contact maintained between military or naval units in order to undertake concerted action; a similar connection between the units of any organization; an illicit relationship between a man and a woman. This word is a cousin to ligature, a connection on the physical level similar to the connection made on an informational level by a liaison.
15. **rapprochement** – a reestablishing of cordial relations. If there is to be an end to war, people and nations must learn to meet each other, to approach each other, on common grounds. That is what this word implies, a coming together in friendship and trust.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. The superpowers agree to a mutual reduction of nuclear stockpiles
(cabal, echelon, rapprochement)
2. A young man breaks the engagement because his fiancé cannot afford a dowry
(caste, liaison, hierarchy)
3. Firemen risk their lives to rescue a trapped buddy (cortege, camaraderie, genealogy)
4. He associates informally with our town’s high society (détente, freemasonry, hobnob)
5. The sermon ended with a call for universal brotherhood and recognition of individual worth (ecumenical, elite, esprit de corps)
6. A funeral procession of hundreds of mourners (cortege, freemasonry, cabal)
7. Police arrest a group of men who were plotting an assassination
(cabal, rapprochement, détente)
8. You receive an offer of a framed history of your ancestors (echelon, genealogy, caste)

9. Speaking a foreign language made the French student invaluable as a link between our two countries (esprit de corps, liaison, hierarchy)
10. Stepping in between the two warring factions, we got them to agree to a cease-fire (elite, hobnob, détente)

II. True or False?

In the spaces provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ___ 1. The *cabal* holds a public forum to discuss the issue
- ___ 2. *Detente* involves risks and compromises by both sides.
- ___ 3. A member of the *elite* feels that the world is his oyster.
- ___ 4. *Esprit de corps* denotes a stronger bond than camaraderie.
- ___ 5. A *liaison* serves a purpose similar to that of a go-between.
- ___ 6. The gossip columnist frequently *hobnobs* with movie stars.
- ___ 7. We paid an expert to research our family's *genealogy*.
- ___ 8. Entering into a *rapprochement*, the cousins continued their bitter fight.
- ___ 9. The producer wanted a young *caste* for his new musical.
- ___ 10. Arnold joined his company's *hierarchy* when he became a vice-president.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. At the highest _____ in our company sit the founder and his two trusted advisers.
2. We formed a _____ group to avoid needless duplication among the three committees.
3. The former society reporter used to _____ with the rich and famous.
4. Baseball managers strive to develop a winning _____ in their locker room lectures.
5. Laden with floral displays, the funeral _____ wound its way into the cemetery.
6. All members of the failed _____ were arrested last night.
7. I picked up the phone in order to bring about a _____ with my twin sister.
8. A study of our _____ revealed our descent from Spanish royalty.
9. Promoted to cardinal, the bishop became part of the church's _____
10. As a member of the _____ group, Hedley was invited everywhere.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly *opposite* in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|---------------------|-------|
| 11. commoners | _____ |
| 12. dissension | _____ |
| 13. hostility | _____ |
| 14. parochial | _____ |
| 15. withdraw | _____ |
| 16. breaking off | _____ |
| 17. disorganization | _____ |
| 18. equality | _____ |
| 19. ill will | _____ |
| 20. unaffiliated | _____ |

Lesson 4

Sounds Italian

Which is the fastest tempo – *andante*, *allegretto*, or *adagio*?

Is *fortissimo* a title given to a high-ranking officer?

Does *libretto* refer to the words or the music?

Which requires more than one note, a *crescendo* or an *arpeggio*?

Which indicates musical skill – *bravura*, *intaglio*, or *imbroglio*?

1. **adagio** – slowly, in music. The plural, *adagios*, refers to a slow movement in music or a slow ballet dance requiring skillful balancing.
2. **andante** – moderate in tempo. This is a musical direction faster than *adagio* but slower than *allegretto*. A slightly faster tempo is given the diminutive *andantino*.
3. **arpeggio** – the playing of the tones of a chord in rapid succession rather than simultaneously.
4. **bravura** – in music, a florid passage requiring great skill and spirit in the performer; a display of daring; a brilliant performance (used as a noun and as an adjective).
5. **contralto** – the lowest female voice or part, between a soprano and a tenor; a woman having such a voice.
6. **crescendo** – a gradual increase in the volume or intensity of sound; a music passage played in *crescendo*. *Crescendo* is also used as a verb.
7. **falsetto** – a typically male singing voice, the result of artificially produced tones in an upper register that go beyond the voice's normal range.
8. **fortissimo** – a very loud passage, sound or tone. The word is also used as an adverb.
9. **imbroglio** – a confused or difficult situation; a confused heap or tangle. The original Latin word describes the situation best – *inbroglio* (“entangled in a bush”)
10. **intaglio** – a figure or design cut beneath the surface of a hard metal or stone; the art of carving in this manner; a gemstone carved in *intaglio*. *Intaglio* is in contrast with cameo, where the design is raised and differs in color from the background.

11. **largo** – in a slow, solemn manner (a direction in music); a slow, broad movement (noun).
12. **libretto** – the text of an opera or other dramatic musical work. It is the Italian diminutive of *libro* (“book”).
13. **salvo** – a simultaneous discharge of firearms; a sudden outburst of cheers or the like. It is not surprising to find that words like *salutation*, *salutary*, *salve*, and *salvation* are related to *salvo* since the Latin *salve* (“hail”), and *salvus* (“safe or well”), form the ancestry of both strands of meaning.
14. **staccato** – music performed with a crisp, sharp attack to simulate rests between successive tones; composed of abrupt, distinct, emphatic parts or sounds. This word is from the Old French word *destachier* (“detach”) and is contrasted with *legato*.
15. **vendetta** – blood feud; a prolonged feud marked by bitter hostility. This is the Italian word for revenge and is related to *vindicate*, our meaning for which is “to avenge.”

Exercises:

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A musical direction
(largo, falsetto, contralto)
2. A volley of rockets
(salvo, adagio, andante)
3. An embarrassing situation
(fortissimo, libretto, imbroglio)
4. A scrawny boy seeking to get even with a bully
(vendetta, bravura, arpeggio)
5. Machine-gun fire
(crescendo, intaglio, staccato)

6. I'm going to get you for that

(largo, vendetta, fortissimo)

7. The story of Carmen

(libretto, arpeggio, falsetto)

8. Sudden loud music drowned out our conversation

(fortissimo, staccato, andante)

9. A female singer with a surprisingly deep voice

(bravura, falsetto, contralto)

10. A carved gemstone

(imbroglio, intaglio, adagio)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. A contralto has a higher-pitched voice than a soprano.

____ 2. If the direction read andante, the music should be played slowly.

____ 3. A man singing in falsetto has probably hit a wrong note.

____ 4. An intaglio design is cut below the surface.

____ 5. A participant in a vendetta tends to harbor unreasonable hatred.

____ 6. A sergeant barked out his commands in staccato fashion.

____ 7. With a salvo of fireworks, the celebration ended.

____ 8. I requested a largo tempo because the music was too slow and solemn.

____ 9. Applause for the winning candidate reached a crescendo.

____ 10. Parents were called to school to settle the imbroglio that had developed between their children.

Lesson 5

1. **alienist**- a doctor who specializes in mental disease. Alienation referring to mental derangement or insanity. Comes from the Latin word aliento (“separation”). Thee question, “Have you taken leave of your senses?” shows the relationship to alienist.
2. **amanuensis**- secretary; one who copies something. IT comes from the Latin menus (“hand”) and ensis (“relating to”). In ancient times a scribe was known as an amanuensis.
3. **beadle**- minor official. Beadle comes from an Old French word that meant (“messenger”)- a man who preceded a procession. The functionary carrying a mace (symbolic club) at the head of a university procession is a beadle.
4. **cosmetologist**- and expert in cosmetics. When a woman applies cosmetics she is putting herself in order. The Latin word cosmos means order in the sense of an orderly universe. Since such order was equated with beauty, when a cosmetologist helps to apply makeup, she is maintaining the classical connection between the two.
5. **dermatologist**- a doctor who specializes in skin problems. From the Greek derma (“skin”). Your epidermis is your outer layer of skin.
6. **entomologist**- a specialist in the study of insects. In Greek, entomos means “cut up.” Insects’ bodies appear to be divided into sections or “cut up.”
7. **farrier**- blacksmith; iron worker. The Latin word ferranus means “of iron.”
8. **graphologist**- a handwriting analyst. In Greek, graphos means “to write.” Graphologist are hired as entertainers today analyzing the handwriting of guests at a party and describing their character traits and aptitudes.
9. **internist**- a doctor who specializes in internal medicine. In Latin, internus means “inward.” Internists are noted as diagnosticians, not surgeons.
10. **lapidary**- an expert in precious stones. Julie Caesar used the word lapis when he meant stone. Lapidaries cut, polish, and engrave stones.
11. **ophthalmologist**- a doctor who treats eyes and their diseases. From the Greek ophthalmos (“eye”). Oculist is a synonym for ophthalmologist. An optometrist prescribes eyeglasses; an optician makes or sells eyeglasses.
12. **ornithologist**- an expert in the branch zoology dealing with birds. It is from the Greek ornis (“bird”).
13. **osteopath**- one who treats ailments by placing pressure on bones and nerves. From the Greek osteo (“bone”) and pathos (“suffering”).

14. **pharyngologist**- a doctor who specializes in diseases of the pharynx, the cavity of the alimentary canal leading from the mouth and nasal passages to the larynx and esophagus.

15. **physiologist**- a biologist who deals with the functions and vital processes of living organisms. It comes from the Greek phsis (“nature”) and logos (“discourse”).

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. You need treatment for tennis elbow. (alienist, ophthalmologist, osteopath)
2. Someone may have forged your signature. (graphologist, cosmetologist, lapidary)
3. “Gnats to you!” (entomologist, farrier, pharyngologist)
4. Teenagers frequently suffer from acne (beadle, dermatologist, amanuensis)
5. “Hey, man, you’re for the birds!” (ornithologist, internist, physiologist)
6. A psychiatrist testifies at a trial (graphologist, beadle, alienist)
7. You go for a routine physical examination (farrier, internist, amanuensis)
8. a sapphire is being appraised by an expert (lapidary, ornithologist, graphologist)
9. Something got stuck in your throat (pharyngologist, cosmetologist, dermatologist)
10. Test for glaucoma (ornithologist, ophthalmologist, physiologist)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false?

- ___ 1. An alienist can give you an opinion about someone’s emotional stability.
- ___ 2. X-rays are usually employed by a competent amanuensis.
- ___ 3. The lapidary knew that the opals would make a great necklace.
- ___ 4. If you have blurred vision, you should consult an ophthalmologist.
- ___ 5. Longfellow wrote, “The Village Farrier.”
- ___ 6. An osteopath is more similar to a chiropractor than he is to a physiologist.
- ___ 7. Estee Lauder, Helena Rubenstein, and Max Factor deal with cosmetologist.
- ___ 8. You seek out a dermatologist to analyze your handwriting.
- ___ 9. A competent amanuensis is worth a great deal to a busy executive.
- ___ 10. An ornithologist, you might say, is for the birds.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. The expensive mascara was recommended by a trained_____.
2. An _____ was hired as a technical advisor for the film The Blob.
3. To relieve my chronic back pain, I consulted an_____.
4. Our talkative parrot was personally trained by a(an)_____.

5. Harold's _____ warned him to stay out of the sun to avoid skin cancer.
6. My little brother was taken to a _____ when he complained of trouble swallowing.
7. We hired a _____ from Tiffany's to cut the diamond expertly.
8. Detailed testimony from a(an) _____ convinced the jury that the defendant had been temporarily insane.
9. A _____ entertained at my cousin's party, analyzing everyone's handwriting.
10. The tear in Martha's retina was diagnosed by a(an) _____.

Lesson 6

Mythology (I)

1. **Adonis:** an exceptionally handsome young man; a plant with solitary red or yellow flowers. Adonis was beloved by both Aphrodite, the goddess of love, and Persephone, the queen of the dead. He was killed by a boar in a hunting expedition and from his life's blood sprang up a crimson flower.
2. **Bacchanal:** a follower of Bacchus (Greek, Dionysus), the god of wine; a drunken reveler; an orgy. Early Greek drama developed in connection with the festival honoring this god.
3. **Cassandra:** a daughter of King Priam and Queen Hecuba of Troy who had the gift of prophecy but was cursed by Apollo so that her prophecies, though true, were fated never to be believed; one who prophecies doom or disaster. The Trojans thought Cassandra was insane and would be destroyed if Paris went to Sparta, and that there were armed Greeks in the Wooden Horse. If either of these prophecies had been heeded, Troy would have been saved.
4. **Cornucopia:** abundance; horn of plenty. Named after the horn of the goat Amalthea that suckled the infant Zeus, the horn is always full of food and drink in endless supply.
5. **Erotic:** concerning sexual love and desire; amatory. Eros was the Greek god of love, identified by the Romans with Cupid and represented as a winged child. While erotic has retained the sexual connotation, cupidity has acquired the meaning of "greed."
6. **Herculean:** tremendously difficult and demanding; resembling Hercules in size, power, or courage. Hercules was the son of Zeus and Alcmene who won immortality by performing Twelve Labors demanded by the jealous Hera.
7. **Hermetic:** made airtight by fusion or sealing; insulated or cloistered; magical. Hermes (Latin, Mercury) was the messenger of the gods and the god of roads, commerce, invention, cunning, and theft. A most versatile god, Hermes is identified with the caduceus, the golden staff with wings at the top and intertwined with serpents, which is the symbol of today's medical profession.
8. **Hydra:** the nine-headed serpent slain by Hercules; a persistent or many-sided problem that presents new obstacles as soon as old ones are solved. The hydra had to be slain by Hercules as one of his Twelve Labors. This monster grew two heads for each one cut off. Hercules finally destroyed the hydra by cauterizing the necks as he cut off the heads.

9. **Hymeneal:** pertaining to marriage; a wedding song or poem. Hymen, the god of marriage, was represented as a handsome youth holding a torch.
10. **Iridescent:** displaying lustrous colors like those of the rainbow. Iris was a messenger of the gods and regarded as the goddess of the rainbow.
11. **Narcissism:** excessive admiration of oneself; egocentrism. Narcissus was a youth who, having spurned the love of Echo, fell in love with his own image reflected in a pool, and after wasting away from unsatisfied desire was transformed into the flower that bears his name. The plant, incidentally, has narcotic effects (from Greek *narke*, “numbness”).
12. **Odyssey:** a long series of wanderings, especially when filled with notable experiences or hardships. *The Odyssey*, called “the greatest tale of all time,” is the second epic of Homer. It recounts the wandering and adventures of Odysseus after the fall of Troy, and his eventual return home to his faithful wife Penelope.
13. **Olympian:** pertaining to the twelve gods of the ancient Greek pantheon whose abode was Mt. Olympus; majestic; incomparably superior; pertaining to the Olympic games. Olympus, the highest mountain in Greece, is located in northern Greece (Macedonia). It is sometimes used synonymously with “heaven” or “the Sky.”
14. **Palladium:** anything believed to provide protection or safety; a safeguard or guarantee of the integrity of social institutions. Palladion was the fabled statue of Pallas Athena that assured the safety of Troy as long as it remained within the city.
15. **Phoenix:** a person or thing of peerless beauty or excellence; a person or thing that has become renewed or restored after suffering calamity or apparent annihilation. The phoenix was a mythical bird of great beauty, fabled to live 600 years in the Arabian desert, to burn itself on a funeral pyre, and to rise from its ashes to live through another cycle. It is an emblem of immortality.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Stung by Cupid’s arrow

(hydra, Cassandra, erotic)

2. A sumptuous feast

(narcissism, cornucopia, odyssey)

3. Joseph's coat of many colors

(iridescent, hymeneal, palladium)

4. Superhuman feats of strength

(Adonis, hermetic, Herculean)

5. Wine, women, and song

(Olympian, bacchanal, phoenix)

6. Admiring himself in the mirror

(narcissism, hymeneal, palladium)

7. The male model appeared on several magazine covers

(hermetic, Herculean, Adonis)

8. This year, designers are using vivid rainbow colors

(iridescent, erotic, bacchanal)

9. Story of the journey of Ulysses

(odyssey, Olympian, palladium)

10. From last place to first place

(phoenix, narcissism, hermetic)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. Phoenix and palladium both suggest permanence.

____ 2. A stick-in-the-mud would be unlikely to engage in an odyssey.

- ____ 3. A narcissist is a lover of flowers.
- ____ 4. A bacchanal would likely attend every wedding feast but his own.
- ____ 5. Cassandra's song would probably be a top seller.
- ____ 6. The happy month held a cornucopia of good news for the family.
- ____ 7. I refuse to deal with iridescent complaints.
- ____ 8. After his plastic surgery, Ronnie was a regular Adonis.
- ____ 9. The president said, "Bringing peace to the Middle East is a Herculean task."
- ____ 10. Feeding the hydra was very costly.

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three.

- | | | | |
|------------------|------------|------------|-----------|
| 1. Cassandra | dramatic | prophetic | doomsday |
| 2. baccalaureate | revelry | bacchanal | Dionysian |
| 3. wisdom | metallic | palladium | safety |
| 4. luxuriant | cornucopia | corpulent | plethora |
| 5. erotic | wandering | digression | desultory |

IV. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

1. When the package was opened, out poured a veritable _____ of goodies.
2. Filling fifty bags of leaves from our lawn in two hours proved to be a _____ task.
3. Like the _____, our last place team rose from the ashes to become champions.

4. The designer filled her dark showroom with _____ fabrics, which brightened it considerably.
5. As I read the autobiography, I followed the author's _____ from poverty to riches.
6. Receiving an Academy Award is akin to scaling _____ heights.
7. Although he had been an ordinary looking teenager, Maxwell developed into a genuine _____.
8. When smallpox destroyed the model's good looks, she was cured of her _____.
9. I always anticipate a victory but my sister remains a _____.
10. The choir and organist launched into a beautiful _____ as the bridal couple entered the chapel.

Lesson 7

Social Sciences

1. **aberrant:** deviating from what is normal or typical. It comes from the Latin *aberrare* (“to go astray”)
2. **anthropomorphism:** attributing human shape to gods, objects, animals. The Greek *anthropo* is a combining form that means “man” or “human”
3. **archetype:** model; original pattern; prototype. One meaning of the Greek prefix *arch* is “main” or chief.”
4. **authoritarian:** characterized by unquestioning obedience to authority. An authoritarian figure is one who rejects individual freedom of judgment and action.
5. **cathedrals:** the relieving of the emotions by art; the alleviation of fears by bringing them to consciousness. This Greek word has played an important role in theater, as well as in psychiatry.
6. **demography:** the science of vital statistics, as of births, deaths, population, etc. It comes from the Greek root *demos* (“the people”) and *graph* (“to write”)
7. **epidemiology:** the branch of medicine that investigates the causes and controls of epidemics. This word is composed of two Greek roots meaning “among the people”
8. **euthanasia:** method of causing death painlessly, mercy killing. In Greek, it means “happy death”
9. extrovert: a person who is active and expressive, a person who is outgoing. The opposite is *introvert*.
10. **psychic:** of the psyche or mind, beyond natural or known physical processes. All of our words that begin with psych comes from the Greek word *pyschikos* (“of the soul”)
11. **psychopath:** a person afflicted with a mental disorder. The Greek root *path* means “suffering” or “diseases”
12. **psychotherapy:** using forms of mental treatment to cure nervous disorders. *Therapy* comes from the Greek *therapeia* (“one who serves or treats medically”)
13. **schizophrenia:** a mental disorder characterized by delusions of persecution and omnipotence. Some victims of this disease are said to have a “split personality”

14. **subliminal:** below the threshold of apprehensions subconscious. *Limen* is a Latin word meaning “threshold”
15. **traums:** an emotional experience that has a lasting psychic effect. The Greek word *trauma* means “wound”

Exercises

I. Which word comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A nurse is suspected of having given an overdoes of drugs to a cancer-ridden patient
(subliminal, euthanasia, anthropomorphism)
2. Researchers examine the tissues of the corpses.
(epidemiology, psychotherapy, psychic)
3. Man bites dog
(aberrant, authoritarian, catharsis)
4. The government issues statistics on the ten fastest growing cities
(schizophrenia, extrovert, demography)
5. A citizen of Hiroshima continues to have nightmares
(archetype, trauma, psychopath)
6. The life of the party
(catharsis, extrovert, trauma)
7. Dr. Jekyll and Mr. Hyde
(schizophrenia, epidemiology, demography)

8. Commands from a dictator

(subliminal, psychic, authoritarian)

9. A family asks the doctors to “pull the plug”

(archetype, catharsis, euthanasia)

10. A Walt Disney show

(trauma, anthropomorphism, subliminal)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. Psychotherapy is used to treat muscles that have atrophied

____ 2. Aberrant behavior is always welcomed by society.

____ 3. Subliminal suggestions tend to be subtle ones.

____ 4. Psychopaths and schizophrenics can be cured quickly today.

____ 5. Jupiter throwing his lightning bolts across the sky is an example of anthropomorphism.

____ 6. Her lawyer claimed that camp experiences led to Helen’s trauma.

____ 7. Our family operates on democratic principles because Dad is an authoritarian figure.

____ 8. The supermarket owners studied the neighborhood’s demography before building the new store.

____ 9. Europe’s Black Plague is a fruitful study for epidemiologists.

____ 10. Euthanasia deals with young people in China.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. It was obvious to the emergency room doctor that the patient had undergone a serious _____.

2. Concern over the so-called “mercy killing” led the clergyman to organize a symposium on _____.
3. The classroom was run in an _____ fashion because the teacher scorned democratic principles.
4. We were confounded by the _____ results of the test in which the poorest students received the highest grades.
5. Study of our neighborhood’s projected _____ will help us to plan for the influx of new families.
6. We usually refer to people with multiple personalities as suffering from _____.
7. The psychologist advanced the theory that the deranged murderer was a _____.
8. As an uninhibited _____, Larry was the life of the party.
9. Since I am dedicated to eliminating infectious diseases, I plan to major in _____.
10. Following a _____ in the final act, the playwright created a happy ending.

IV. What’s the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. democrat _____
2. normal _____
3. conscious _____
4. shy one _____
5. poor example _____

Lesson 8

From Sunny Spain

1. **aficionado:** a fan; devotee. Although this word originally described bull-fighting fans, it is now used to refer to devotees of all sports.
2. **barrio:** part of the city where Spanish-speaking people live; ghetto.
3. **bonanza:** rich pocket of ore; any source of wealth. In Spanish it means “fair weather at sea.” A popular television program of the 1960s was entitled “Bonanza”
4. **bravado:** pretended courage
5. **desperado:** bold outlaw; dangerous criminal. The relationship to our word “despair” is apparent. One who is without hope can be a dangerous criminal.
6. **flotilla:** a small fleet. The Spanish word *flota* means “fleet” *Flotilla*, then, is a diminutive form of *flota*.
7. **grandee:** a nobleman of the highest rank
8. **hacienda:** large estate; country house. The Old Spanish word *facienda* meant “estate.” The change from f to h is apparent in many words.
9. **lariat:** lasso; a rope used for tethering grazing horses. *Reata* is “rope” in Spanish.
10. **machismo:** manly self-assurance; masculine drive; virility.
11. **manana:** tomorrow; at some indefinite time in the future. There is a perjorative twist to *manana*, suggesting laziness.
12. **palmetto:** small palm tree
13. **renegade:** deserter; turncoat; traitor. In Spanish, the word *renegado* means “to deny.”
14. **siesta:** midday nap. In Spanish and Latin American countries businesses often close at midday to allow for siesta time.
15. **torero:** bullfighter on foot. The *toreador* was a bullfighter on horseback, but that term is no longer used since all bullfighters today are toreros.

Exercises

I. Which word comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. You go to see a performance of the opera “Carmen”

(lariat, flotilla, torero)

2. The calendar pictures a man asleep under a tree next to a lawn mower.

(barrio, bravado, manana)

3. A young man starts a fight to impress his girlfriend.

(machismo, siesta, renegade)

4. You win the lottery

(aficionado, bonanza, palmetto)

5. There is a wild police chase after the bank robber

(desperado, grandee, hacienda)

6. The FBI arrests a man for selling U.S. secrets to a foreign country

(aficionado, renegade, grandee)

7. Stores in Spain close for two hours after lunch

(siesta, hacienda, palmetto)

8. The Nina, the Pinta, and the Santa Maria

(flotilla, barrio, manana)

9. David stands up to Goliath

(desperado, lariat, bravado)

10. A bull-fighting fan shouts, “Ole!”

(bonanza, aficionado, barrio)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. A truly courageous person does not have to resort to bravado.
- _____ 2. Feminists have contempt for those men who display machismo.
- _____ 3. Ordinarily a grandee might take a siesta in his hacienda
- _____ 4. The Spanish Armada was too awesome to be described as a flotilla.
- _____ 5. A lariat can be the high point of a Spanish meal when it is seasoned properly.
- _____ 6. The spectators applauded the torero for his fearlessness.
- _____ 7. We bought an expensive barrio as a wedding gift
- _____ 8. Our winning lottery ticket proved to be a bonanza
- _____ 9. General Parker promised amnesty for any renegade who turned himself in.
- _____ 10. Because of his lifelong philanthropy, the desperado was honored at a White House ceremony.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

- 1. Since Teddy is an _____ of baseball, we got him two tickets to the World Series.
- 2. Refreshed by her _____, Maria was ready to go to work.
- 3. As fish prices declined, the _____ of shrimp boats was cut in half.
- 4. Our new mayor proposed to tear down sections of the _____ and build middle-income housing.
- 5. The _____ was caught up on a horn of the bull and badly injured.
- 6. With unexpected _____, the young man confronted the bully.
- 7. Movie cowboys generally are proficient with a _____.

8. “Au revoir, so long, ciao, _____” she said as her taxi pulled away.
9. A photograph of the _____ appeared on the Most Wanted list in our post office.
10. On Navy Day, we stood upon the pier to watch the _____ sail into the Harbor.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. cowardice _____
2. patriot _____
3. today _____
4. weakness _____
5. lawman _____
6. loss _____
7. state of alertness _____
8. shack _____
9. peon _____
10. wealthy neighborhood _____

Lesson 9

1. anachronism: anything that is out of place in time. It is formed by the combination of the Greek roots *ana* (“against”) and *chronos* (“time”)
2. anon: soon; shortly. Used as an abbreviation, anon. means “anonymous”
3. antebellum: before the war; especially before the American Civil War. This word is formed from the Latin Prefix *ante* (“before”) and the root *bellum* (“war”)
4. antediluvian: old-fashioned; before the flood. The Latin word for “flood” is *diluvium*.
5. atavism: reversion to a primitive type; resemblance to a remote ancestor. The Latin *atavus* means “father of a great-grandfather.”
6. augury: the art of prophecy; an omen. The original Latin word *augur* means “priest who presides at fertility rituals.”
7. betimes: early; promptly; before it is too late.
8. biennial: happening every two years. Biennial should not be confused with biannual, which means “twice a year”
9. diurnal: daily; of the daytime. *Diurnal* is contrasted with nocturnal
10. eon: long, indefinite period of time; thousand years.
11. ephemeral: short-lived; transitory. *Ephemeros* is a Greek word meaning “for the day”
12. epoch: noteworthy period. It comes from a Greek word meaning “pause” – almost as if mankind takes time out before entering a new important phase
13. generation: the period of time between the birth of one group and that of its offspring. A generation is about 30 years.
14. score: twenty people or objects; twenty years. It comes from the Greek word for a “scratch” or “mark” used in keeping tallies.
15. tercentenary: a period of 300 years. *Ter* is the Latin prefix for “three” and *centenary* means “hundred”

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A woman wearing a style of dress that is completely out of date

(epoch, antediluvian, diurnal)

2. Emperor Nero looking at his wristwatch

(tercentenary, ephemeral, anachronism)

3. A young man following in his grandfather's footsteps

(anon, atavism, score)

4. You meet your old classmates every two years at a reunion

(antebellum, betimes, biennial)

5. Your fortune is told by a gypsy

(augury, generation, eon)

6. They had been married for two decades

(eon, score, diurnal)

7. The painter believed that everyone was entitled to fifteen minutes of fame

(ephemeral, epoch, tercentenary)

8. Many inventions were introduced during the industrial Revolution

(anon, epoch, atavism)

9. Plantation life was a feature of the South in the early 1800s

(antebellum, generation, anachronism)

10. My family chore is to walk the dog each day

(biennial, antediluvian, diurnal)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. Abraham Lincoln's "Fourscore and seven" was 87 years
- _____ 2. Ephemeral is the opposite of "permanent"
- _____ 3. Someone who comes to you betimes takes his time about it
- _____ 4. Cotton was the great crop of the antebellum South
- _____ 5. The United States will have its tercentenary celebration in 2076
- _____ 6. An entire generation has grown up using personal computers
- _____ 7. To show a modern man driving up in a new car is an anachronism.
- _____ 8. Dinner will be served anon
- _____ 9. The frightening augury lashed out at the startled travelers.
- _____ 10. Our previous biennial reunion was in 1997 so we expect the next one in 1999

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

- 1. We spotted an _____ in the movie when Julius Caesar looked at his wristwatch.
- 2. In the next decade, our company will issue five _____ journals.
- 3. Industrialization spelled the end of an era for the _____ southern states.
- 4. The Beatles started a musical _____ that has gained worldwide acceptance.
- 5. Because of the _____ gap, Roger found it difficult to relate to his grandson.
- 6. My grandfather's _____ notions need updating.
- 7. With the evident power of _____, Liza could predict the future.

8. Guido's interest in philately proved to be _____ because he sold his entire collection.
9. It seemed to take an _____ before the traffic jam allowed us to get moving again.
10. Breakfast was preceded invariably by a _____ prayer that helped Roy get through the rest of the day.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. now _____
2. late _____
3. modern _____
4. permanent _____
5. nightly _____
6. something relevant _____
7. nightly _____
8. postwar _____
9. an instant _____
10. an advance _____

Lesson 10

Short but Challenging Words

1. bane- cause of death, ruin or distress. Obviously, you would avoid *baneful* herbs, like *baneberry*, and even shun *baneful* superstitions that could be equally harmful.
2. deign- to think it beneath one's dignity, condescend; give. Related to the same Latin root, *dignitas*, as *deign* are *dignity*, *dignify*, *dignitary*, and *indignant*, all of which comment on one's worthiness.
3. eke-to supplement; to manage to make a living with difficulty; to use fugally. *Eke* can be traced to the Latin *augere* and the Greek *auxanein*, which in turn give us words like *augment* and *auxiliary*.
4. knell-to ring in a slow, solemn way; toll; to call or announce by a mournful ringing; an omen of death or failure. The opening line of Gray's famous elegy, "The curfew tolls the *knell* of parting day," sets the mournful, reflective mood of the poem.
5. mete-to allot, distribute or apportion. Tennyson's famous line amply illustrates the sense of measuring out: "I *mete* and dole unequal laws unto a savage race."
6. moot- discussion or argument of a hypothetical law case; debatable; so hypothetical as to be meaningless. Law students sharpen their skills in a *moot* court where hypothetical cases are tried.
7. mulct-to punish by a fine or by depriving of something; to extract by fraud or deceit. It is from the Latin *mulcta* ("a fine.").
8. plumb-perfectly vertical; directly; to test or sound with a plumb line (measure); to discover the facts of; to fathom; solve or understand. A lead weight (Latin *plumbum*, "lead") was used at the end of the plumb line. The chemical symbol for lead is Pb.
9. quail-to draw back in fear; lose heart or courage; cower. A *quail* is also a partridge-like bird mentioned in the Bible as the source of the meat sent to the Israelites in the desert. The definition of the verb to *quail* is related to the Latin word *coagulare* ("coagulate"), describing what seems to happen physically when the blood "runs cold."
10. roil-to make a liquid cloudy or muddy; to stir up or agitate; to make angry, rile. Some authorities believe the word comes from the Old French word for "rust" or "mud," or the Latin *ruber* ("red"). Others frankly admit the origin is unknown. But we can offer some interesting synonyms: *annoy*, *fret*, *ruffle*, *exasperate*, *provoke*.

11. ruck-a heap or stack; a large quantity or crowd; mass of ordinary people or things; common run. Some words, like *queen*, which one referred to anyone's wife, have moved up the social ladder; but *ruck* succeeded only in moving from things to humans. It still refers to people who are generally inferior.
12. shunt-to move or to turn to one side; to shift or switch from one track to another. The word may be related to *shun*, which also has the sense of turning away.
13. svelte-slender and graceful; suave; polished. The derivation from the Latin *evellare* ("to pull out"), implies that the svelte figure has, been "drawn out" like a heated glass tube.
14. thrall-a slave or bondman; a person under the moral or psychological domination of something or someone; slavery. Performers who enthrall their audiences captivate their attention.
15. tryst-an appointment, as by lovers; to meet. In Scotland the word refers to a market, but the Old French *triste* ("hunting rendezvous") suggests that the Gallic hunters were not always after wild game.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. The impoverished family barely survived the winter

(mulct, moot, eke)

2. To each according to his due

(thrall, mete, roil)

3. A house of terror for its inhabitants

(quail, ruck, deign)

4. Romeo and Juliet meet at the Friar's cell

(knell, tryst, shunt)

5. Drink was his undoing

(svelte, plumb, bane)

6. A detour off the main road

(plumb, thrall, shunt)

7. Most models diet strenuously to keep their slender figure

(svelte, ruck, mulct)

8. The town rings a bell at curfew time

(knell, deign, mete)

9. Children annoying their nanny

(roil, shunt, tryst)

10. She would like a slave in her aunt's household

(moot, thrall, plumb)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. One would normally be proud to be counted among the *ruck* of humanity.
- ____ 2. The best time to appeal to someone for a favor is after he has been *roiled* up.
- ____ 3. The *knelling* of bells has a somber, saddening effect.
- ____ 4. Every girl is anxious to have a svelte figure.
- ____ 5. A person found guilty of a serious crime in *moot* court must serve at least the minimum service
- ____ 6. Drugs and alcohol proved to be the *bane* of Peter's life.
- ____ 7. Mrs. Miller was so angry that she would not *deign* to read my poem..
- ____ 8. The greedy stockbroker *mulcted* his firm into bankruptcy.
- ____ 9. It was difficult for the poor farmers to *eke* out a living.
- ____ 10. Judge Medowar has *meted* out justice in his courtroom for twenty years.

III. Synonyms and Antonyms

Indicate whether the following pairs of words are the same, opposite, or unrelated in meaning by writing S, O, or U in the space provided.

____ 1. thrall—master

____ 2. moot—questionable

____ 3. tryst—confidence

____ 4. mete—assign

____ 5. roil—soothe

Lesson 11

Medical Science

1. **abscess**-swollen, inflamed area of body tissues. It is from the Latin *abscessus* (“to grow from”). It was originally thought that the humors (liquids) went from the body into the swelling.
2. **aphasia**-loss of the power to use or understand words, usually caused by brain disease or injury.
3. **arteriosclerosis**-a thickening and hardening of the walls of the arteries as in old age.
4. **biopsy**-the cutting out a piece of tissue for diagnostic examination by microscope.
5. **cadaver**-dead body; corpse for dissection. It is from the Latin word *cadere*, which means “to fall.”
6. **carcinogen**-any substance that causes cancer.
7. **comatose**-as if in a coma; lethargic. The Greek word *coma* means “deep sleep.”
8. **etiology**-the science of the causes and origins of disease.
9. **malingerer**-one who fakes illness and pretends to be suffering.
10. **mastectomy**-the surgical removal of a breast.
11. **prosthesis**-replacement for a missing part of the body.
12. **simian**-of or like a monkey or an ape.
13. **therapeutic**-curative; serving to heal.
14. **tumescence**-swelling.
15. **vasectomy**-the surgical removal of a duct that conveys the male sperm—the *vas deferens*

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Eugene O'Neill's play, *The Hairy Play*
(vasectomy, biopsy, simian)
2. The Federal Drug Administration's report on harmful food additives
(aphasia, carcinogen, prosthesis)
3. Breast surgery
(etiology, malingerer, mastectomy)
4. Days of anxious waiting for the unconscious patient to awaken
(abscess, comatose, therapeutic)
5. A disease of old age
(tumescence, cadaver, arteriosclerosis)
6. Malignant or benign
(comatose, biopsy, aphasia)
7. Visit to the morgue
(cadaver, abscess, simian)
8. A great pretender
(etiology, malingerer, carcinogen)
9. Walking with a wooden leg
(prosthesis, comatose, arteriosclerosis)
10. Vigorous exercise
(therapeutic, tumescence, apasia)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. Good news can serve as a *therapeutic* drug for many patients.

- ____ 2. Speech therapy is prescribed for many people who suffer from *aphasia*.
- ____ 3. When the government suspects the presence of a *carcinogen* in a food, it
increases sales and distribution
- ____ 4. A wooden leg was a common *prosthesis* years ago.
- ____ 5. Most motion picture horror stories have at least one *cadaver* to boast about.
- ____ 6. After the doctor drained my *abscess*, I immediately felt better.
- ____ 7. While awaiting the results of the *biopsy*, Eleanor fainted.
- ____ 8. Snakes have a traditional *simian* characteristic.
- ____ 9. Researchers are at work on the etiology of lung cancer.
- ____ 10. In a *comatose* state, Manute was able to resume his basketball career.

Lesson 12

Animal World

1. **bovine**-an ox, cow, or related animal; having oxlike qualities; slow, dull, stupid, or stolid.
2. **equine**-a horse; of, like, or a characteristic of a horse.
3. **feline**-a member of the family that includes lions, tigers, jaguars, and wild and domestic cats; resembling or suggestive of a cat, as in suppleness, slyness, treachery, or stealthiness
4. **hircine**-of or characteristic of a goat, especially in strong odor or lustfulness. Pan, the god of woods, fields, and flocks, had a human torso with goat's legs, horns, and ears. He is often represented as frightening the nymphs in the forest.
5. **leonine**-of, pertaining to, or characteristic of a lion. Like Felix the cat and Bossie the cow, Leo the lion takes his name from the original Latin.
6. **lupine**-wolflike; rapacious or ravenous
7. **ophidian**-snakelike; a snake or serpent
8. **ovine**-designating sheep or sheeplike; an ovine animal
9. **piscine**-of, pertaining to, or typical of a fish or fishes. Pisces, the twelfth sign of the zodiac, is also called "the fish."
10. **porcine**-of or pertaining to swine or pigs; piglike. The cartoon character Porky the Pig derives his name from the Latin *porcus*, pig.
11. **saurian**-of or having the characteristics of lizards; a lizard. The names of the prehistoric animals, like the dinosaur and the brontosaur, used combining forms with the Greek root *saurios* ("lizard").
12. **taurine**-of or resembling a bull. The second sign of the zodiac is Taurus the bull.
13. **ursine**-of or characteristic of a bear. The constellations Ursa Major and Ursa Minor, popularly called the Big Dipper and the Little Dipper, appeared to be ancients to have the outlines of a "Great Bear" and a "Little Bear."
14. **vixen**-a female fox, a quarrelsome shrewish or malicious woman. Vixen can be used as an adjective.

15. **vulpine**-of, resembling, or characteristic of a fox; clever, devious, or cunning.
The famous play *Volpone*, or *The Fox*, was an early seventeenth-century drama by Ben Jonson.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Carmen signs to her lover before he enters the arena

(bovine, saurian, taurine)

2. The sour-grapes fable

(equine, vulpine, leonine)

3. Little Bo Peep

(vixen, ovine, feline)

4. A lady-killer

(lupine, ophidian, porcine)

5. Sure-footed mountain climber

(ursine, piscine, hircine)

6. The Adam and Eve story

(vixen, ovine, ophidian)

7. The Kentucky Derby

(feline, equine, porcine)

8. Meow

(hircine, feline, saurian)

9. MGM movies start with the lion's roar

(leonine, ursine, piscine)

10. In 1996 Great Britain had to deal with “mad cow” disease

(ovine, vulpine, bovine)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. *Ophidians* and *saurians* had much in common
- _____ 2. Both lions and tigers can be described as *leonine*.
- _____ 3. Horse racing would be impossible without *equines*.
- _____ 4. An aquarium would house many *ursine* creatures.
- _____ 5. A *bovine* and *taurine* animal make a natural pair.
- _____ 6. Overeaters are often described as *porcine*.
- _____ 7. Because Lou loved dogs, he received an award from the *Feline* Society of America.
- _____ 8. *Hircine* milk is taken from brown cows only.
- _____ 9. The actor who starred as a vampire was given a *lupine* appearance.
- _____ 10. We rely on our *ovine* animals for warm woolen garments.

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three.

- | | | | |
|--------------|----------|---------|------------|
| 1. equity | equine | equerry | equestrian |
| 2. ephemeral | fleeting | feline | transient |
| 3. shrew | vexing | virago | vixen |
| 4. bullish | matador | terrain | taurine |
| 5. anger | finny | piscine | angular |

Lesson 13

Countdown Numbers

1. atonement-amends for wrong-doing; expiation. The theological use of this word can be readily understood if it is interpreted to mean “being at one” with God. Taking the proper action to correct an injury or repaid a relationship.
2. bicameral-composed of two houses, chambers, or branches. It is easy to identify the prefix *bi*, which we find in *bicentennial*, *biceps*, and *binomial*. The second part, obviously related to *camera* tells us that photography, like the legislature, requires a chamber in which to function
3. Decalogue-the Ten Commandments. The precepts spoke by God to Israel on Mt. Sinai are the basis of Mosaic Law.
4. decimate-to destroy a great number or proportion of. The word is traceable to the cruel punishment for mutiny—selecting by lot and killing one in every ten people. The same Latin root, *decem* (“ten”), gives us *decimals*, *decade*, and even *December* (the tenth month if u begin as the Romans did, with March).
5. dichotomy-division into two usually contradictory parts or opinions. The Greek root means something cut in two. In modern usage the word has special significance in logic (a division into mutually exclusive groups) and in *botany*(a branching into two equal subdivisions)
6. double-think-the belief in two contradictory ideas at the same time. This, as well as other forms of Newspeak, was formulated by George Orwell in his novel, *1984*
7. millennium-a span of a thousand years; a period of general righteousness and happiness, especially in the indefinite future
8. nihilism-total rejection of established laws and institutions; total destructiveness toward the world and oneself. The *nihilist* adopts the extreme position that nothing exists or can be communicated; hence, he lives in a lonely, empty world.
9. penultimate-next to last. The Latin *paene* (“almost”) and *ultimus* (“last”) combine to form this word
10. primeval-original; belonging to the first or earliest ages. It is important to differentiate between primeval and its synonyms; *prime* “first in numerical order” and *primitive* “suggesting the simplicity of original things.” Other synonyms are *pristine* and *primordial*.
11. protocol-forms of ceremony and etiquette observed by diplomats and heads of states; the first copy of a treaty or document. The Greek roots refer to the first leaf glued to the front of the manuscript and containing the notes of the contents.

12. quatrain-a stanza or poem of four lines, usually with alternate rhymes
13. quintessence-the most perfect embodiment of something; the purest or most typical instance. In ancient philosophy, the fifth and highest essence *quinta essentia* (“either”) was supposed to be the constituent matter of the heavenly bodies, the others being air, fire, and water.
14. tessellated-like a mosaic; checkerboard. A variety of the Latin *tessera* (“four”), the word finds its most practical application in art, architecture and the building trades.
15. untrammelled-unhampered; unrestrained. The fishermen of the Middle Ages made a three-layered net (*tres macula*) of varying degrees of coarseness so that the fish would be entangled in one of more the meshes

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Negotiations to settle a strike are broken off
(atonement, dichotomy, double-think)
2. A young lady practices curtsying for hours in preparation for meeting royalty
(quatrain, tessellated, protocol)
3. A Golden Age is just around the corner
(quintessence, millennium, bicameral)
4. A baseball game’s eight inning
(penultimate, decimate, untrammelled)
5. The radicals weapons were terrorism, rioting, and subversion
(primeval, nihilism, Decalogue)
6. A chemical company has to make payments to victims of pollution
(protocol, atonement, quatrain)

7. Locusts will destroy most of the crop

(decimate, penultimate, primeval)

8. God and Moses

(bicameral, nihilism, Decalogue)

9. The model was described by many as being a symbol of pure beauty

(quintessence, double-think, tessellated)

10. A meeting of Senate and House leaders

(untrammeled, bicameral, quatrain)

II. True or False?

In the spaces provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

_____ 1 Double-think suggests a careful analysis of both sides of a problem.

_____ 2. A tessellated floor and a quatrain of poetry are both related to the same number.

_____ 3. The Decalogue is a play with ten speaking parts

_____ 4. A prisoner being released from jail feels untrammeled.

_____ 5. Dichotomy and bicameral have prefixes with the same meaning.

_____ 6. As part of the German's atonement, they had to pay reparations to the state of

Israel

_____ 7. The Black Plague severely decimated Europe's population.

_____ 8. Our complete agreement pointed up the remaining dichotomy between us.

_____ 9. Many cities planned celebrations for the millennium.

_____ 10. The real estate developer's nihilism led him to a successful career as a builder.

III. Fill in the Blank.

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. Observing the proper _____, Mrs. Berman curtsied before the monarch.
2. In an act of _____, the former criminal contributed a million dollars to the family he had swindled.
3. Scientist fear that a new virus could _____ much of Europe's population.
4. Abandoning his youthful adherence to _____ Ned became a constructive thinker and responsible citizen.
5. Numerous _____ species are being destroyed each year as mankind continues to pollute the forests and the waterways.
6. Our _____ of opinions on euthanasia will be addressed in a debate.
7. The candidate's hoped-for image is that he is the _____ of honesty.
8. After dessert as the _____ course, the meal ended with coffee.
9. Some previous dictatorships have given way to constitutional _____ legislative bodies.
10. When the entire class scored 1000% on the spelling test, my teacher exclaimed, "The _____ has arrived!"

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided.

1. restrained _____
2. modern _____
3. final _____

4. togetherness

5. governance

6. lack of regret

7. add to

8. blank

9. rudeness

10. dictatorial

Lesson 14

Legal Language

1. **adjudicate:** to hear and settle a case by judicial procedure. A transitive verb, adjudicate means to settle the rights of the parties in a court case. As an intransitive verb, it means simply to act as a judge
2. **appellate:** having the power to hear appeals and to reverse lower court decisions. An appellant is the one who appeals from a judicial decision or decree. An appellee is one against whom an appeal is taken.
3. **collusion:** a secret agreement for a deceitful or fraudulent purpose; conspiracy. Though the word has a serious connotation today, it is derived from the Latin ludere (“to play”), and ludus (“game”). A collusion often implies an attempt to defraud a person of his rights by the forms of law.
4. **deposition:** testimony under oath, especially a written statement by a witness for use in court in his or her absence. In ordinary usage, deposition refers to the act of depriving of authority, or the placing or laying down, as of a sediment or precipitation.
5. **equity:** something that is just, impartial, and fair; the value of a business or property in excess of any claim against it; justice applied in circumstances not covered by law.
6. **exhume:** to dig out of the earth; disinter; reveal. From the Latin humus (“ground”).
7. **incommunicado:** without the means or right of communication with others, as one held in solitary confinement.
8. **intestate:** having made no valid will; one who dies without legal will.
9. **ipso facto:** by the fact itself; by the very fact.
10. **lien:** the right to take and hold or sell the property of a debtor as security or payment for a debt; mortgage. The word is related to the Latin ligare (“to blind”) indicating that certain possessions are bound or tied to the payment of the debt.
11. **litigation:** legal action or process. A person who will sue at the drop of a hat, a handkerchief, or a word is said to be litigious.
12. **perjury:** the deliberate, willful giving of false, misleading, or incomplete testimony by a witness under oath in a criminal proceeding.
13. **pettifogger:** a petty, quibbling, unscrupulous lawyer; a shyster. Shyster comes from the American lawyer Scheuster, who in 1840 was rebuked in court for his objectionable

practices. Pettifogger, similarly, is derived from the pettiness of the Fuggers, a sixteenth-century German family of financiers and merchants.

14. **tort**: any wrongful act not involving breach of contract for which a civil suit can be brought. The Latin tortum (“twisted”), is related to torque, a twisting force, and torture.

15. **tribunal**: a seat or court of justice. The tribune was the Roman official chosen by the plebeians (commoners) to protect their rights against the patricians (wealthy class)

Exercises

Which word comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. No evidence of a will was found

(equity, intestate, litigation)

2. Any statement made now can be held against you

(deposition, tort, ipso facto)

3. If we do not get satisfaction here, we will take this case to a higher court.

(collusion, tribunal, appellate)

4. The witness has told only half the story in court

(adjudicate, perjury, exhume)

5. Lie low till the furor subsides

(incommunicado, pettifogger, lien)

6. The basketball players all agreed to lose the game

(equity, collusion, perjury)

7. Fido’s remains were dug up and buried elsewhere

(exhume, ipso facto, adjudicate)

8. Debts had to be paid before we could acquire the house

(lien, incommunicado, tribunal)

9. He conspire to get me fired

(exhume, appellate, tort)

10. In and out of court regularly

(collusion, litigation, equity)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

____ 1. A collusion is an intellectual clash between two strong lawyers.

____ 2. An adjudicated settlement is one made out of court.

____ 3. Torts involve an injury or damage done without breach of contract.

____ 4. A pettifogger is overly concerned with trifles.

____ 5. Ipso facto refers to facts, like axioms, that are universally accepted.

____ 6. We turned to the appellate division to get justice.

____ 7. A deposition is related to a proposition.

____ 8. The government's witness was held incommunicado.

____ 9. Because he died intestate, no surgery was required.

____ 10. Different American Indian families belong to special tribunals.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. It would take a Solomon to _____ the difficult child custody case.

2. There were contradictions between David's recent testimony and his earlier _____.
3. We were greatly relieved when the court lifted the _____ against the sale of our home.
4. Some people sue at the drop of a hat but most prefer to avoid _____.
5. When both stores offered the exact sale prices, we began to suspect _____ between the managements.
6. I am searching for _____, not an unfair advantage.
7. The suspected spy was held _____ for 48 hours.
8. As an eighteenth-century revolutionary _____, the French nobleman was found guilty.
9. Although he was cautioned about committing _____, the witness continued to lie.
10. Since my uncle died _____, the family has spent a fortune trying to get its hands on the bulk of his estate.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|---------------|-------|
| 1. bury | _____ |
| 2. truth | _____ |
| 3. partiality | _____ |
| 4. accessible | _____ |
| 5. legal act | _____ |

Lesson 15

Appearances and Attitudes (II)

1. **circumspect**: careful; cautious; prudent. The original meaning of this word was “to look about.” A person who “looks about” is cautious-hence, circumspect.
2. **demure**: modest; shy. It comes from a Latin word that means “mature” or “proper”
3. **dispassionate**: fair; impartial; calm.
4. **dolorous**: painful; mournful
5. **edacious**: devouring; consuming. It comes from the Latin edere (“to eat”)
6. **effete**: worn out; spent and sterile. The Latin word effetus means “that which has brought forth offspring”
7. **feisty**: touchy; excitable; quarrelsome
8. **flaccid**: weak; feeble; flabby.
9. **flippant**: disrespectful; saucy; impertinent.
10. **florid**: ruddy; rosy; ornate. Florid also means “highly-colored,” which reveals its connection with the Latin word for flower, floris.
11. **glabrous**: bald, smooth
12. **imperious**: overbearing; arrogant; domineering. It is easy to see the relationship of this word to emperor.
13. **ingenious**: clever; original; inventive; resourceful.
14. **intractable**: hard to manage; unruly; stubborn.
15. **intransigent**: uncompromising; refusing to come to an agreement.

Exercises

Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A married man takes his secretary to a dark restaurant.

(florid, circumspect, intransigent)

2. My father is the absolute boss in our house

(dispassionate, glabrous, imperious)

3. An argument is in progress; neither side wants to give in.

(intractable, flaccid, edacious)

4. The night club comedian upset his conservation audience

(flippant, dolorous, effete)

5. A blush stole over the teenager's cheek.

(feisty, ingenious, demure)

6. Our pit bull is hard to handle

(feisty, circumspect, flippant)

7. The inventor devised a gadget that can work miracles

(glabrous, florid, ingenious)

8. She cried at the sad organ music

(effete, edacious, dolorous)

9. Not much hair for the barber to cut

(flaccid, glabrous, demure)

10. We'll never give in

(intransigent, dispassionate, edacious)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

____ 1. Intransigent people are definitely intractable

- ____ 2. A glabrous person is usually vain about his attractive hair
- ____ 3. The winner's headquarters was filled with dolorous sounds when the victory was announced
- ____ 4. Julius Caesar's imperious manner befitted his position as a dictator.
- ____ 5. Clark Kent's effete appearance was a way of disguising his true identity as Superman.
- ____ 6. Shut away from sunlight for two years, Vanya's face had a florid glow.
- ____ 7. After strenuous gym workouts, my cousin's muscles are no longer flaccid.
- ____ 8. Quentin's flippant responses caused him to be suspended from school.
- ____ 9. The English actor impressed us with his circumspect behavior and reserved manners.
- ____ 10. Dolorous music tends to liven up any party.

III. Fill in the blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. Surprisingly, it was a teenager who devised an _____ solution to the scheduling problem.
2. The _____ baseball manager was ejected after pushing the umpire.
3. Several irate customers complained about the _____ attitudes of our salespeople.
4. When the private detective was hired, he was reminded of the need to be _____.
5. Private Williams had to do fifty push-ups because of his _____ answers to Sergeant Doyle.

6. Our pleas were in vain because Ernesto had adopted an _____ position.
7. The transition from hard-bitten cynic to a _____ young thing was unrealistic.
8. As we approached the funeral parlor, _____ music greeted our ears.
9. Baseball umpires are expected to be _____ in rendering their decisions.
10. Governor Walsh's pompous acceptance speech was filled with _____ language.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. careless _____
2. virile _____
3. hairy _____
4. flexible _____
5. pale _____
6. opinionated _____
7. arrogant _____
8. dull _____
9. respectful _____
10. calm _____

Lesson 16

Mystery and the Occult

1. alchemy – a method of miraculous change of one thing into another. In the Middle Ages, the chief aim of honest and dishonest experimenters was to change base metals into gold and to discover the elixir of eternal youth
2. arcane – beyond comprehension; mysterious; secret. The Latin word arcanus means “shut up” or “hidden”
3. conundrum – a riddle; any puzzling question or problem
4. demonology – the study of demons or of beliefs about them.
5. exorcise – to drive away an evil spirit by charms or incantations
6. inscrutable – mysterious; completely obscure; unfathomable
7. pallor – lack of color; unnatural paleness
8. phenomenology – the science that classifies and describes unusual happenings.
9. polygraph – an instrument that records changes in blood pressure, respiration, pulse rate, etc; a lie detector
10. purloin – to steal
11. ritual – a system of rites, religious or otherwise; a prescribed form or procedure; ceremony
12. shamus – private detective. The caretaker of a synagogue is also called a shamus
13. soothsayer – one who predicts the future. Sooth is an Anglo-Saxon word meaning “true,” hence, a soothsayer is a “sayer of truth”
14. thaumaturgy – magic; the supposed working of miracles
15. warlock – sorcerer; conjurer; male witch. From the Anglo-Saxon word for traitor or liar. A warlock was supposed to be able to cast a magic spell because of a compact he made with the Devil.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind”

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. The last page of the murder mystery, with all the guests in the living room

(thaumaturgy, demonology, shamus)

2. "As I gaze into my crystal ball...."

(warlock, soothsayer, arcane)

3. "Man, your face is as white as a ghost's"

(pallor, conundrum, inscrutable)

4. A pickpocket's nimble fingers

(purloin, alchemy, ritual)

5. "Would you be willing to take a test to prove your innocence?"

(exorcise, phenomenology, polygraph)

6. A good poker player's face

(alchemy, inscrutable, thaumaturgy)

7. With the IQ of a genius, Luz can solve any mathematical puzzle

(conundrum, warlock, ritual)

8. An alien warship was reported to have flown over Seattle

(phenomenology, demonology, shamus)

9. We recite the Pledge of Allegiance each morning

(exorcise, soothsayer, ritual)

10. At the museum we needed an expert to explain the meaning of the strange painting

(arcane, purloin, alchemy)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

____ 1. A warlock has military responsibilities.

____ 2. To wear your heart on your sleeve is to have an inscrutable expression.

____ 3. A cattle rustler is one who would purloin a sirloin.

- ____ 4. When we say, “It’s Greek to me,” we are referring to something that is arcane.
- ____ 5. Abracadabra is the start of a familiar ritual.
- ____ 6. My father’s stockbroker practiced alchemy by converting our assets into debits.
- ____ 7. I was shocked by the shut-in’s pallor.
- ____ 8. After months of exorcise, Tonio was in great shape.
- ____ 9. Accused of theft, the bank teller offered to submit to a polygraph.
- ____ 10. Macbeth’s witches area subject for demonology.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. Harry Houdini, the celebrated magician, was a master of _____
2. As part of his morning _____, Andre shined his shows, pressed his trousers, and put a flower in his buttonhole.
3. Many employers would like their workers to take _____ tests, but the unions oppose that procedure.
4. Helen may know several _____ languages, but that hasn’t helped her to earn a living in today’s society.
5. A famous mathematical _____, which has stumped the experts for a century, recently was solved with the aid of a microcomputer.
6. Through some amazing _____, the shy reporter became Superman.
7. The Edison Hotel hired a _____ to deal with recent thefts.
8. A waxen _____ had come over Audra’s usually florid face.
9. Colonel Snyder’s mission was to _____ the enemy’s atomic documents.
10. Awaiting the announcement of the Academy Awards, the composed actor maintained an _____ expression.

Lesson 17

Size and Shape

1. **archaeology**: the systematic recovery by the scientific methods of material evidence remaining from man's life and culture in past ages, and the detailed study of this evidence.
2. **elfin** – fairylike; delicate; small and charmingly merry or mischievous. In folklore, an elf was a tiny, often prankish fairy who lived in the woods and possessed magical powers, like Shakespeare's Puck.
3. **infinitesimal** – too small to be measured. Mathematicians, philosophers, and photographers are accustomed to dealing in concepts that range from the infinite (too large to be measured) to the infinitesimal
4. **Lilliputian** – very small; tiny, narrow-minded; petty. In Swift's *Gulliver's Travels*, the hero was shipwrecked on the island of Lilliput, the inhabitants of which stood six inches tall.
5. **megapolis** – an extensive, heavily populated, continuously urban area, including any number of cities. This larger than a metropolis since it includes an inner city, suburbia, and any adjacent towns.
6. **minimize** – to reduce to a minimum; decrease to the least possible amount or degree; belittle. Again we meet a synonym for "small." *minim*, this time combined with the suffix *ize*, "to make," and denoting as in the definition for infinitesimal, making something appear to be of the least possible amount, value, or importance
.
7. **minutiae** – small or trivial details; trifling matters. The word is not restricted in meaning to unimportant details since a seemingly minor point can prove to be of major significance

8. **palatial** – like a palace; large and ornate. A closely related word derived from the same Latin root palatine (palace), refers to royal privileges, a high official, a Roman soldier as well as to the chief of the seven hills upon which Rome was built.

9. **peccadillo** – a small sin or fault. We admire the person who dresses impeccably, “without fault,” perhaps are tolerant to the peccadillos of our friend; and probably forgive the person who offers his peccavi (confessions, or literally “I have sinned)

10. **picayune** – of little value or account; petty or prejudiced. Originally, this meant a coin of small value. Inevitably, the meaning was transferred to a person of low esteem because of his or her criticism or bias.

11. **simulacrum** – a slight, unreal, or superficial likeness or semblance; an image or representation of something

12. **soupcon** – suspicion; a slight trace or flavor; a very small amount.

13. **teeming**: swarming; prolific or fertile. The Old English word *terman* meant “to produce offspring.” Indeed, an obsolete meaning of teeming was “to become pregnant and produce offspring.” What is perhaps more interesting is that our word team also comes from the Old English *team*, which meant “childbearing” or “brood”

14. **titanic**: of enormous size, strength, or power. In classical mythology the Titans were a race of giants who ruled the world before gods and goddesses. Cronus, perhaps the most famous (think of our word chronology), swallowed all his children in an attempt to avert a prophecy of doom, but one son, Jupiter (Zeus), survived and eventually overthrew his father.

15. **vista**: a far-reaching intellectual view, a view or prospect, especially one seen through a long, narrow avenue or passage; a mental view extending over a long period of time or embracing many remembrances or experiences.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. The myriad molecules on the head of a pin
(infinitesimal, vista, picayune)
2. The two cities have grown so quickly you can hardly tell where one ends and the other begins.
(megalopolis, Lilliputian, palatial)
3. Most of their points were scored when our best man was in the penalty box
(amplitude, elfin, minimize)
4. Mac stumbled once over his lines but otherwise his performance was perfect
(minutiae, peccadillo, simulacrum)
5. This is the biggest rocket in our arsenal.
(soupcon, titanic, teeming)
6. The seven dwarfs of Disney
(Lilliputian, palatial, vista)
7. I was bogged down in petty details.
(megalopolis, minutiae, titanic)
8. We took a guided tour of Buckingham Palace
(teeming, palatial, soupcon)
9. The defense kept objecting to every minor point that was raised in court
(picayune, elfin, peccadillo)
10. After climbing to the top of the mountain, we looked out on a marvelous landscape.
(minimize, teeming, vista)

II. True or False?

In the space provided indicate whether each statement is true or false

- ____ 1. An elfin creature is huge and lumbering
- ____ 2. Soupcon is the call to dinner
- ____ 3. You should feel complimented if your mental powers are called Lilliputian

- ____ 4. Vista galleries are so called because they attract many visitors.
- ____ 5. A teeming street is dilapidated and deserted.
- ____ 6. It took a titanic effort to open the car door under water.
- ____ 7. The amplitude of the harvest gratified the farmers.
- ____ 8. In summers, we seek to trade our megalopolis for the country air.
- ____ 9. Don't minimize Fermi's contributions to the development of the atomic bomb.
- ____ 10. My parents are willing to overlook an occasional peccadillo.

III. Synonyms and Antonyms

Find and circle two words on each line which are either synonyms or antonyms.

- | | | | |
|------------------|-------------|-------------|----------|
| 1. infinitesimal | titanic | pompous | hopeful |
| 2. swarming | cooperative | teeming | moderate |
| 3. economy | amplitude | pettiness | range |
| 4. picayune | searching | serviceable | unbiased |
| 5. exaggerate | imitate | minimize | assemble |

Lesson 18

Words with Tales attached

1. accolade: praise or approval; an embrace of greeting or salutation. When French generals kiss the cheeks of the man being honored, they are continuing a custom of the early French kings who placed their arms around the neck (Latin ad “to” and colum “neck”) of the new knight in order to kiss him. William the Conqueror used his fist to confer knighthood. Later a gentle stroke with the flat of the sword on the side of the neck became the accepted method.
2. conclave: a private or secret meeting; an assembly or gathering, especially one with authority, power, and influence. When a pope is to be elected, the College of Cardinals meets in a room locked on the inside and outside. No one is permitted to leave until a new pope has been chosen. From Latin, then, a conclave is a meeting in a room locked with (con) a key (clavis). You can recognize the same root in clef, clavicle, and conclude.
3. dirge: a funeral hymn; a slow sad song, poem, or musical composition; a lament. Dirge is a contraction of the first word of a Latin funeral service that begins, “Dirge, Domine...” (“O Lord, direct my way in Thy sight”) This in turn is based on the words of a Psalm. (“...Make Thy way straight before may face”)
4. draconian: harsh or vigorous; a law or code of extreme severity. Draco was an Athenian lawgiver whose code or laws, established in 621 B.C., called for the most severe penalties for the smallest offense.
5. epicurean: devoted to the pursuit of pleasure; fond of the good food, comfort, and ease. The followers of Epicurus are associated with the pursuit of pleasure, so that Epicureanism has become synonymous with luxurious living. The early Epicureans were contrasted with the Stoics, followers of Zeno, who taught that the wise man should be free from passion and submissive to natural law. The Stoic today is one who endures the hardships of life without complaint.
6. gossamer: soft, sheer, gauzy fabric; fine film of cobwebs seen in autumn; anything delicate, light or insubstantial. Lexicographers theorize that this word, derived from Middle English goose and somer, was first used as a name for Indian summer, when geese were in season.
7. immolate: to kill, as a sacrifice; ;to destroy or renounce for the sake of something else. Ground grain or meal (Latin mole) was sprinkled by the Roman priest on the head of an animal before it was sacrificed. Later, this preparatory act of sprinkling, immolation, came to mean the sacrifice itself.
8. juggernaut: anything that exacts blind devotion or terrible sacrifice; any terrible, irresistible force. Juggernaut is the Hindu god whose idol is dragged in a religious

procession on an enormous car. Devotees are sometimes crushed under the wheels of the advancing car. The word today is applied to any large, overpowering, destructive force or object such as war, a giant battleship or a powerful football team.

9. junket: a party, banquet, or an outing; a trip taken by an official and paid for with public funds. Junket began as a Latin word *juncos* (“a twig”) and referred to as basket made of rushes and twigs. Soon the word was applied to delicacies, especially cream and cheese preparations served in these baskets. Finally, it became the feast served out of doors, a picnic. The political slant to junket probably stems from the clambakes or beef-and-pretzel-feasts once offered by political clubs to their followers. After moving into the political sphere, the word acquired its modern meaning of an official trip underwritten by the taxpayer—a long way from the twigs and cheese.

10. ostracism: a rejection or exclusion from a group or society by general consent. In ancient Athens, if the assembly decided a person was endangering the public welfare or liberty a vote was taken to send the guilty one into exile. A potsherd or oyster shell (from the Greek *ostrakon*) on which was written the name of the person to be ostracized was dropped into an urn. The modern blackballing of members from organizations closely follows this method.

11. proletariat: the working class; the unprotected class. *Proles*, a Latin word for “offspring” is the source of proletariat or the poor class, who, because they were prolific, served the state only by producing offspring.

12. rigmarole: confused, incoherent, foolish talk; a complicated and petty procedure. Rigmarole is an alternation of *ragman roll*, a series of documents in which the Scottish noblemen acknowledged their allegiance to Edward I of England.

13. rubric: a title, heading, or direction in a book written or printed in red or otherwise distinguished from the rest of the text; an established custom or rule of procedure; a short commentary or explanation covering a broad subject. In the monasteries, the monks who copied the works of the ancient authors often adorned their manuscripts with beautiful decorations. For headings, they followed the Roman practice of using red ink (Latin *rubra*). Thus rubric came to mean not only the initial ornamental letters but also the directive or rule of conduct that was often part of the heading.

14. Socratic: Pertaining to Socrates or his philosophical method of repeated questioning to elicit truths implicit in all rational beings. Socrates, a Greek philosopher and the chief speaker in Plato’s *Dialogues*, developed his ideas by constantly asking questions or forcing admissions from his opponents. Condemned to death for irreverence to the gods and corrupting the youth, Socrates is now remembered as a seeker after truth and a man who taught his disciples how to think.

15. sycophant: a self-seeking, servile flatterer; fawning parasite; one who attempts to win favor or advance himself by flattering persons of influence. Since the Greek roots mean “showing figs,” two possible explanations have been offered for the story behind

sycophant. One is that the gesture of a fig was used to denounce a criminal, making a sycophant an informer. The other is more literal. it was unlawful to export figs and one who reported such an act was called a sycophant, or fig-shower. The modern meaning derives from the informer's cringing and servile manner.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement , then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. They are the backbone of our industrial power

(rubric, proletariat, juggernaut)

2. The silent treatment

(conclave, dirge, ostracism)

3. In some underdeveloped countries, a thief is punished by having his hand cut off.

(Socratic, draconian, junket)

4. Eat, drink, and be merry

(epicurean, immolate, sycophant)

5. This play describes the Drama Critics' Award.

(accolade, rigmarole, gossamer)

6. The president and his cabinet deliberated for three hours.

(rubric, conclave, dirge)

7. Screen stars are often surrounded by flatterers

(sycophant, immolate, proletariat)

8. Detective Brady went through the lengthy process of reading the prisoner his rights

(juggernaut, accolade, rigmarole)

9. Belonging to the library board allowed me to take many expense-free trips to conventions

(sycophant, dirge, junket)

10. The wailing of the widow could be heard over the sound of the organ at the funeral.

(dirge, ostracism, draconian)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. A sycophant speaks with sincerity
- ____ 2. A dirge would be inappropriate at a wedding.
- ____ 3. A rigmarole is a tall masted sailing ship
- ____ 4. A rubric has to be written in red
- ____ 5. A model sailing ship in a bottle is a good example of a juggernaut.
- ____ 6. Professor Smith lectured the entire period in true Socratic fashion
- ____ 7. With accolades still ringing in his ears, the star thanked the audience.
- ____ 8. The warden resorted to draconian measures to get the truth out of the felon.
- ____ 9. His alibi, lacking in substance, was as light as gossamer.
- ____ 10. Harold organized a taxpayer's protest against congressional junkets.

III. Synonyms and Antonyms

Indicate whether the following pairs of words are the same, opposite, or unrelated in meaning by writing S.O. or U in the space provided.

- ____ 1. ostracism-acceptance

- ____ 2. accolade--encomium
- ____ 3. immolate--soften
- ____ 4. rigmarole--fabrication
- ____ 5. epicurean--pleasure-bound

IV. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

1. After their leader's death, the government radio station began to broadcast a _____.
2. We felt that the new rules were _____, but our protests were unheeded.
3. The first victims of AIDS were subject to _____, by people who were generally ignorant of the disease.
4. In order to get a loan, you have to go through a tremendous _____ at a local bank.
5. The famous movie producer was surrounded by _____.
6. The Chicago Bulls _____ rolled over their opponents with startling ease.
7. In addition to the loud _____, each star received a floral tribute.
8. The revolution's leaders sought to win the support of the _____.
9. At an all-night _____, the angry reporters decided to resign.
10. With his _____ tastes, Vincenzo found it easy to mingle with the sybarites.

Lesson 19

Of Loves and Fears and Hates

1. acrophobia: abnormally intense fear of being in high places.
2. bibliophile: one who loves books; a book collector. The opposite is a biblioclast.
3. claustrophobia: an abnormal dread of being in closed or narrow spaces. One who has a fear of open spaces suffers from agoraphobia.
4. Francophile: an admirer of France, its people, and its customs. It may also be used as an adjective.
5. hydrophobia: fear of water; rabies. One of the symptoms of the disease caused by the bite of a rabid animal is an inability to swallow; hence, the name hydrophobia for the disease itself.
6. misanthropy: hatred of or distrust of mankind. The misanthropist has his opposite in the philanthropist, that is, one who loves mankind—and has the means to support worthy causes.
7. misogyny: hatred of women
8. paranoid: showing unreasonable distrust, suspicion, or an exaggerated sense of one's own importance. Paranoia is usually a chronic condition characterized by delusions of persecution or of grandeur that the afflicted strenuously defends with apparent logic and reason.
9. philately: the collection and study of postage stamps, post marks, and related materials. The derivation, from the Greek philo. (“loving”), and ateles (“without charge”) reminds us that the original stamp indicated a tax-free shipment.
10. Philistine: a stupid, ignorant, especially middle-class person who is held to be indifferent or antagonistic to artistic and cultural values; boorish or barbarous; an ignoramus or outsider.
11. phylogeny: love of or fondness for women.
12. philology: historical and comparative linguistics; the study of human speech, especially as the vehicle of literature; literary or classical learning. The philologist is known by other related labels, the philologer and the philologue.
13. Russo phobia: dislike or fear of Russia or its policies

14. triskaidekaphobia: fear of the number 13. Though the word is long, the arithmetic etymology from Greek is simple: treis (“three”), kai (“and”), and deka (“ten”)

15. xenophobia: an unusual fear or contempt of strangers or foreigners, especially as reflected in one’s political or cultural views.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Bats and beavers are prone to this

(claustrophobia, hydrophobia, phylogeny)

2. No member of the famous trapeze artist, The Flying Valencias, ever had this

(Francophilism, misanthropy, acrophobia)

3. Jack the Ripper must have been one

(misogynist, philatelist, philologist)

4. Beware of Friday the 13th

(bibliophile, triskaidekaphobia, Philistine)

5. Many U.S. citizens like anything that is American and detest anything else

(xenophobe, Russophobe, paranoid)

6. In an elevator, invariably I grow nervous

(phylogeny, claustrophobia, philology)

7. My uncle spends every vacation in Paris

(Francophile, xenophobia, bibliophile)

8. Our neighbors trust nobody, absolutely nobody!

(acrophobia, Philistine, paranoid)

9. Franklin D. Roosevelt was a noted stamp collector

(philately, misanthropy, phylogeny)

10. At the start of A *Christmas Carol*, Scrooge hates everybody.

(bibliophile, misanthropy, triskaidekaphobia)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. A bibliophile is a file clerk in a library.
- _____ 2. A Francophile would feel quite at home in Philadelphia
- _____ 3. you can assume that a hermit is a misanthrope.
- _____ 4. Some men dream of having a harem, but not the misogynist
- _____ 5. A philistine would be a frequent visitor to the museums
- _____ 6. Scholars who specialize in philology are likely to be expert musicians
- _____ 7. His xenophobia led him to retire from the world.

Lesson 20

Science “Ology” Words

1. archaeology: the systematic recovery by scientific methods of material evidence remaining from man's life and culture in past ages, and the detailed study of this evidence.
2. cardiology: the medical study of the diseases and functioning of the heart. Emphasis on prevention and treatment of heart disease has made most people familiar with cardiographs, the curve that traces the mechanical movements of the heart.
3. ecology: the science of the relationships between organisms and their environments. This field is also called bionomics.
4. endocrinology: the physiology of the ductless glands, such as the thyroid or adrenal, whose secretions pass directly into the blood stream from the cells of the gland.
5. gerontology: the scientific study of the physiological and pathological phenomena associated with aging. The Greek stem geront (“old”), explains the source of the names of such popular medicines as Geritol.
6. gynecology: a branch of medicine that deals with women, their diseases, hygiene, and medical care.
7. morphology: the biological study of the form and structure rather than the functioning of living organisms. In linguistics, morphology, denotes the study of word formations, including the origin and function of inflections and derivations.
8. necrology: a list or record of people who have died, especially in the recent past.
9. neurology: the medical science of the nervous system and its disorders.
10. paleontology: the study of fossils and ancient life forms. Paleo is a combining form indicating “ancient” or “prehistoric.”
11. pathology: the scientific study of the nature of disease, its causes, processes, development, and consequences; the anatomic or functional manifestations of disease.
12. rhinology: the anatomy, physiology and pathology of the nose. The Greek root rhinoceros (“nose-horned”), explains how the rhinoceros got its name.
13. seismology: the geophysical science of earthquakes and of the mechanical properties of the earth.

14. speleology: the scientific study or systematic exploration of caves
15. toxicology: the study of the nature, effects, and detection of poisons and the treatment of poisoning.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Fears that the Alaskan pipeline will destroy the delicate balance of animal life in the region

(neurology, archaeology, ecology)

2. A special panel on diseases of the aged

(endocrinology, gerontology, rhinology)

3. The honored list of soldiers who made the supreme sacrifice

(necrology gynecology, toxicology)

4. The monster left an impression of his footprint in the rock

(paleontology, morphology, seismology)

5. The Dead Sea Scrolls were hidden for centuries in the Qumran cave

(cardiology, speleology, pathology)

6. The plastic surgeon made a sketch of his patient's new nose

(rhinology, toxicology, speleology)

7. With permission from the Egyptian government, we began our dig

(archaeology, endocrinology, morphology)

8. We were stunned when the young basketball player succumbed to a heart attack

(ecology, gerontology, cardiology)

9. Some California cities have endured dozens of serious earthquakes

(necrology, paleontology, seismology)

10. The cadaver's appearance suggested that he might have been poisoned

(gynecology, toxicology, neurology)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

_____ 1. Archaeology and paleontology could be dealing with the same material

_____ 2. Mr. Rohas opened the door to the gynecologist's office, gulped, and realized he was in the wrong place.

_____ 3. Every cardiologist must have a repertoire to demonstrate his dexterity with a deck of cards.

_____ 4. Morphology is concerned with finding pain killers.

_____ 5. Pathologists work closely with engineers to construct safe, durable roadways.

_____ 6. In a study of the area's ecology, we determined the extent of pollution.

_____ 7. When visiting Grandma in her health-related facility, I discussed her case with the gerontologist on duty.

_____ 8. With an interest in speleology, they learned the difference between stalagmites and stalactites.

_____ 9. Modern-day seismologists can predict rainy weather with great accuracy.

____ 10. Our town maintains a necrology of those citizens who died in our country's wars.

III. Putting the Scientists in the Proper Place:

For each of the following pairs indicate yes in the space provided if the scientist is correctly paired with the "tools of his/her trade" and no if not.

- | | |
|------------------------|-----------------|
| ____ 1. archaeologist | arches |
| ____ 2. gerontologist | aged people |
| ____ 3. morphologist | drugs |
| ____ 4. seismologist | Richter scale |
| ____ 5. pathologist | charts and maps |
| ____ 6. paleontologist | fossils |
| ____ 7. speleologist | caves |
| ____ 8. toxicologist | serums |
| ____ 9. rhinologist | zoo animals |
| ____ 10. necrologist | old coins. |

Lesson 21

Appearances and Attitudes

1. **jejune**: barren; flat; dull. The Latin word jejunos means “empty”
2. **libidinous**: characterized by lust; lewd; lascivious. In psychoanalytic theory, the libido is the driving force behind all human action
3. **licentious**: morally unrestrained; lascivious. This is derived from an Old French word that meant “license” and referred to an abuse of liberty or undisciplined freedom.
4. **mercurial**: changeable; volatile. These adjectives are characteristic of the heavy, silver-white metallic element mercury. In Roman mythology the swift messenger of the gods, Mercury was volatile, quick-witted, eloquent, and manually skillful.
5. **meretricious**: flashy; tawdry; falsely alluring. It is from the Latin word meretricious (“prostitute”)
6. **minatory**: menacing; threatening
7. **mutable**: inconstant; fickle; tending to frequent change. In biology, a mutation is a change in some inheritable characteristic.
8. **niggardly**: stingy; miserly. Niggardly comes from a Norman French word meaning “to rub” or “to pinch.” A pennypincher is niggardly.
9. **nonchalant**: cool; indifferent; without warmth or animation. It comes from a French root, chaloir (“to care for”)
10. **noxious**: unwholesome; harmful to health. The Latin nocere means “to hurt”
11. **obdurate**: hardhearted; inflexible; not easily moved to pity.
12. **obtuse**: slow to understand; dull.
13. **officious**: meddlesome; offering unnecessary and unwanted advice.
14. **omniscient**: having infinite knowledge; knowing all things.
15. **pusillanimous**: cowardly; fainthearted in Latin, “tiny mind”

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A Chinese fortune cookie accurately predicts your future

(jejune, omniscient, licentious)

2. Eight poker players puffing on cigars in your living room

(noxious, officious, niggardly)

3. You receive an anonymous letter hinting at violence

(libidinous, minatory, nonchalant)

4. Your father absolutely refuses to let you borrow his car

(meretricious, obtuse, obdurate)

5. The Lion in *The Wizard of Oz*

(pusillanimous, mercurial, mutable)

6. It doesn't take much to upset James to the point of exasperation

(mutable, mercurial, noxious)

7. Maxine can't make up her mind about which dress to wear

(jejune, meretricious, mutable)

8. Jose had abandoned five wives, but he was ready to try again

(licentious, pusillanimous, niggardly)

9. Malcolm blames everyone but himself for his failures

(obtuse, licentious, nonchalant)

10. Nothing seems to excite him

(officious, nonchalant, minatory)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- _____ 1. The conservative congregation was quite pleased with the minister's libidinous position.
- _____ 2. One of our most coveted military awards, the Purple Heart, is given to those who have distinguished themselves by pusillanimous actions in combat.
- _____ 3. An officious bank manager can make his tellers uneasy.
- _____ 4. Putting a \$50 bill in the church collection plate is a niggardly gesture
- _____ 5. Interior decorators generally abhor meretricious furniture
- _____ 6. Clara spoke in a jejune tone that attracted everyone's attention.
- _____ 7. Being of a mercurial temperament, Tom could not restrain his delight.
- _____ 8. A noxious element in human relations inclines people to be forgiving
- _____ 9. Becoming omniscient is unattainable even for the greatest among us.
- _____ 10. Anxious to achieve a quick success, the president dispatched his most obtuse negotiator

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

- 1. The _____ nature of the negotiators made it likely they would come to blows
- 2. The professor's _____ attitude about any subject led us to regard him with awe and discomfort
- 3. Being human is equivalent to being _____ for, as Heracleitus said, change is the only permanence we can count on.
- 4. Twenty years of _____ living had taken its complete toll of Mr. Bodack.
- 5. The marriage proposal was made in such a(n) _____ manner that Gloria doubted its sincerity.
- 6. The fumes from the gigantic fire were judged to be so _____ that the authorities issued a general evacuation order for nearby homes.

7. Alvin's generous offer to call the bout a draw was mistakenly regarded as a(n) _____ act.
8. When Iris learned that the role of Roxanne required her to wear _____ garb, she opted to turn down the offer.
9. Elizabeth's _____ interference did not endear her to the people in her office.
10. Only after Bob had spent an exciting, eye-opening year in the Peace Corps did he realize the _____ monotony of his previous life.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|-----------------|-------|
| 1. friendly | _____ |
| 2. extravagant | _____ |
| 3. harmless | _____ |
| 4. stouthearted | _____ |
| 5. yielding | _____ |
| 6. acute | _____ |
| 7. ignorant | _____ |
| 8. zealous | _____ |
| 9. extravagant | _____ |
| 10. chaste | _____ |

Lesson 22

Legal Language

1. **amicus curiae**: a friend of the court; a lawyer or layman who advises the court on a legal matter
2. **arson**: the crime of setting fire to property in order to collect insurance
3. **barrister**: lawyer in England. A barrister practices at the bar, or court of justice.
4. **embezzle**: to steal money that was entrusted to your care.
5. **extradition**: turning over a fugitive from one jurisdiction to another. The root of the word is the Latin *trachtio* (“the act of handing over”)
6. **habeas corpus**: a court order requiring that a prisoner be produced to determine the legality of his imprisonment; a procedure that lawyers use to get clients out of illegal detention. In Latin it means “to have the body.”
7. **immaterial**: without substance; unimportant
8. **incarcerate**: to jail; confine
9. **indeterminate**: having inexact limits; indefinite
10. **larceny**: theft. Grand larceny involves theft in excess of a fixed sum, whereas petty larceny refers to a less consequential theft.
11. **litigious**: quarrelsome; given to carrying on lawsuits
12. **miscreant**: villain; criminal; evil person. The original meaning was “unbeliever” or “heretic.” From there it was easy to jump to “villain”
13. **perpetrator**: a person who commits an offense
14. **plagiarism**: passing off someone else’s writings or ideas as your own. The Latin word for kidnaper is *plagiarius*
15. **probation**: a period of testing or trial. This refers to a suspension of sentence on the condition that the convicted person demonstrates good behavior in order to stay out of jail.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A prominent psychiatrist offers to help out in a court case

(perpetrator, larceny, amicus curiae)

2. The fire marshal suspects foul play

(probation, arson, immaterial)

3. Detectives fly across the border to bring back a suspect

(indeterminate, extradition, habeas corpus)

4. A scholar suggests that Shakespeare was not especially original

(plagiarism, incarcerate, miscreant)

5. The crooked bank manager fears the day when his books will be audited

(litigious, embezzle, barrister)

6. Sal was sentenced to five to ten years in jail

(probation, indeterminate, larceny)

7. The teacher quickly recognized that Gary's report was beyond his capacity

(larceny, immaterial, plagiarism)

8. The jury found the defendant guilty as charged

(barrister, litigious, miscreant)

9. The bank officer suddenly acquired unexplainable wealth

(litigious, embezzle, incarcerate)

10. Enid made a proposal that had no connection to the problem

(immaterial, probation, extradition)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. Burning down a building is an act of larceny.
- _____ 2. Litigious people provide a good income for lawyers
- _____ 3. An alert lawyer can use a writ of habeas corpus to keep his client out of jail before charges are brought against him.
- _____ 4. When you embezzle funds you misuse money that has been entrusted to you.
- _____ 5. That which is immaterial is usually critical in any court case.
- _____ 6. A miscreant is likely to be involved in grand larceny
- _____ 7. Probation is an investigative procedure to determine if a crime has been committed
- _____ 8. A perpetrator is someone who betrays his country
- _____ 9. A barrister would likely be familiar with court procedure
- _____ 10. A person guilty of arson could sometimes be charged with murder.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. Anyone who believes “there is a little _____ in everyone’s heart” is merely trying to rationalize his own failing.
- 2. The rigorous _____ period was intended to discourage unsuitable applicants
- 3. Murder was added to the _____ change when the firemen discovered a body in the burned out structure
- 4. The terrorist sought refuge in a country where he believed he would be free from _____.
- 5. _____ may not be punishable by a prison sentence but it can cost a pretty penny and ruin a reputation.
- 6. The unexpected appearance of a(n) _____ gave the prosecution the impetus to follow through to a guilty verdict.
- 7. The British _____ may sound more sophisticated but he is in reality the same as a U.S. lawyer

8. Paul, ever the romantic, told Peggy she was guilty of _____ for she had stolen his heart.

9. It is hard to believe that the club treasurer would _____ the money entrusted to him.

10. The police collared the _____ but lacked witnesses or evidence to get an indictment.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|---------------|-------|
| 1. important | _____ |
| 2. release | _____ |
| 3. forgiving | _____ |
| 4. precise | _____ |
| 5. paragon | _____ |
| 6. reimburse | _____ |
| 7. benefactor | _____ |
| 8. easy-going | _____ |
| 9. definite | _____ |
| 10. liberate | _____ |

Lesson 23

Foreign Terms

1. **avant-garde**: the leaders of a movement; vanguard. Avante-garde people are generally regarded as some reformers, people with new ideas who are somewhat ahead of their time.

2. **bete noire**: someone or something that is feared or disliked. In French, the two words mean “black beast.” A black sheep was an eye-sore in the flock, its wool was less valuable. If something is your bete noire, you do your best to avoid it; it is a thorn in your side.

3. **bot mot**: a bright saying; witticism. In French, bon means “good,” and mot means “word.” A clever remark or ad lib is often labeled as bon mot.

4. **coup de grace**: the shot or blow that brings death; the finishing stroke. The actual French meaning is “blow of mercy.” The officer in charge of a firing squad administers the coup de grace by firing a bullet into the victim’s head after his men have shot.

5. **cul-de-sac**: a passage or street with only one outlet; a situation from which there is no escape; an argument that leads nowhere. In French it means “bottom of the sack.”

6. **dues ex machina**: someone who intervenes unexpectedly to solve a dilemma. The literal Latin meaning is “god out of the machine.” In the ancient theater the first few acts laid out the problems facing the characters and when no solution was apparent, a “god” was lowered onto the stage and helped to resolve the issues.

7. **fait accompli**: something that is already done so that there is no use in debating it. In French, “an accomplished fact.”

8. **fin de siecle**: referring to the last years of the nineteenth century; decadent. The French meaning is “end of the century.”

9. **gauche**: awkward; lacking grace; without tact. It is French for “left-handed.” Lefties were thought to be clumsy (sinister in Latin). Another French meaning is “warped”

10. **junta**: a political group that seeks to control a government; a faction or cabal. In Spanish this word originally meant “to join.” In Spain, a junta was a legislative assembly; the word was corrupted to junto, which meant “clique” or “faction.” Today, we use the original word with its changed meaning.

11. **laissez-faire**: hands-off policy: letting business operate without government interference. There was a mid-eighteenth century school of French economists whose

motto was laissez-faire, laissez-passer (“let us alone, let us have free passage for our goods”)

12. **mot juste**: the right word; exact phrase

13. **non compos mentis**: incapable of handling one’s own affairs; insane. In Latin, “not of sound mind.” This could be said of someone who has lost his memory and understanding by reason of disease or accident.

14. **non sequitur**: in logic this is a conclusion that does not follow from the evidence; a remark that seems out of place. The Latin meaning is “it does not follow.”

15. **sine qua non**: an essential condition; that which is indispensable. The Latin meaning is “without which not.”

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A murderer who pleads temporary insanity

(laissez-faire, non compos mentis, cul-de-sac)

2. An ailing horse is being put out of his misery

(coup de grace, mot juste, gauche)

3. Several schemers plan a take-over

(fait accompli, junta, sine qua non)

4. You ask for her age and she says, “I’m five feet tall.”

(bete noire, fin de siecle, non sequitur)

5. Alban Berg was a composer who experimented with atonalities

(avant-garde, bot mot, dues ex machine)

6. The discussion centered around how history would characterize the last years of the twentieth century

(non sequitur, avant-garde, fin de siècle)

7. Loss of trust in a do-nothing leadership

(fait accompli, laissez-faire, junta)

8. The right word at the right time

(bot mot, gauche, non compos mentis)

9. It's a pity but there was no alternative

(non sequitur, non compos mentis, sine qua non)

10. A weak spot

(bête noir, cul-de-sac, mot juste)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. Being born in this country is a sine qua non for anyone running for presidency

____ 2. If you are in the avant-garde, you are inclined to the conservatism.

____ 3. Someone who always seems to get the better of you is your bête noire.

____ 4. It is considered gauche to sip your coffee from the saucer

____ 5. "Open sesame" was the mot juste

____ 6. Non sequitur refers to a leader who has no following

____ 7. A fait accompli is a done deed

____ 8. Laissez-faire invites people to do their own thing with few restrictions

____ 9. A creative writer will not find it necessary to resort to *deus ex machine*

____ 10. The fleeing criminal was lucky to find a cul-de-sac

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

1. The accused hoped his _____ responses would corroborate his insanity plea.
2. The revelation that all the hero's adventures were really a dream is the kind of _____ that suggests a lack of originality by the author.
3. The thief was cornered when the police chased his car into a _____.
4. The military _____ promised to hold democratic elections as soon as the turmoil subsided.
5. As we approach the twenty-first century, I wonder if we will regard our _____ as decadent as the previous one.
6. According to some pundits, the _____ that is threatening the president's reelection bid is his own wife.
7. Isn't it strange that the _____ you searched for at the party escaped you till you got home?
8. The discussion of abortion inevitably ends in a(n) _____.
9. The _____ for success in business is a wealthy father-in-law.
10. We laughed at Perry's interest in a political career because his outstanding trait is his way of expressing himself.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. superfluous _____
2. dexterous _____
3. competent _____
4. conservative _____
5. incipience _____
6. perfectly logical _____
7. strictness _____
8. just getting started _____
9. guardian angel _____
10. graceful _____

Lesson 24

En Français

1. **coiffure** : a style of hair arrangement
2. **demarche** : a line of action ; change of policy. Demarche comes from the French *marcher* (« to walk »)
3. **denouement**: the final outcome of the intricacies of a plot. The French meaning is “the untying of a knot”
4. **éclat**: acclaim; brilliant success. The French word *eclater* means “to burst out”
5. **élan**: enthusiasm; ardor; vigor. Its original meaning was “to throw a lance.”
6. **entrepreneur**: one who organizes and manages a business undertaking
7. **impasse**: difficulty without a solution; stalemate; blind alley
8. **ingénue**: actress playing an innocent, inexperienced young woman
9. **malaise**: a feeling of discomfort or uneasiness. In French, *mal* mean “bad” and *aise* means “ease”
10. **mélange**: mixture; hodgepodge. The French verb *mélanger* means “to mix.”
11. **repartee**: quick, witty reply, wit. The French meaning is The quick return of a thrust or blow.
12. **sangfroid**: composure; equanimity. In French it means “cold blood”
13. **tete-a-tete**: intimate conversation between two people. The literal meaning is “head-to-head”
14. **tour de force**: a feat of strength or skill
15. **vignette**: an anecdote; a brief literary composition.

Exercises

I. Which Word Come to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A cold-blooded killer

(vignette, sangfroid, mélange)

2. There is a loud applause for the star of *Hamlet*

(tour de force, demarche, malaise)

3. You get together with your brother for a serious conversation.

(denouement, entrepreneur, tete-a-tete)

4. Two rival hostesses emerge abashed after some sharp word play

(repartee, coiffure, éclat)

5. A producer advertises his search for a 14-year old Juliet

(élan, impasse, ingénue)

6. The surprise ending was a stroke of genius

(demarche, éclat, denouement)

7. The non-stop 120hour session failed to produce an agreement

(élan, impasse, vignette)

8. A feeling that things are going wrong

(sangfroid, malaise, demarche)

9. Hard to identify but easy to recognize

(mélange, vignette, élan)

10. An idea worth trying

(demarche, coiffure, melange)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. The denouement of a mystery story should satisfy every one of the readers' questions.
- _____ 2. In order for success in most projects, a certain degree of élan is required
- _____ 3. The bargainers reached an impasse, and everyone went home satisfied with the way the strike had been concluded
- _____ 4. A man with sangfroid could stare a gunman in the eye and not show his fear
- _____ 5. Madame de Pompadour was noted for her coiffure
- _____ 6. The entrepreneur attributed his success to his long years of experience
- _____ 7. The newly appointed general suggested a demarche that had eluded his predecessors
- _____ 8. The starring role of the ingénue was played with éclat by the young actress
- _____ 9. The vignette caught our attention but its inordinate length eventually put us to sleep
- _____ 10. Repartee may be compared to a duel without swords.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. The novel was spiced with a(n) _____ of saucy tales, personal recollections, and outrageous exaggerations
- 2. The octogenarian _____ had only a fifth grade education, but he had outsmarted the most savvy competitors
- 3. Mischa, not blessed with the gift of _____, could only answer the insult with an embarrassed stammer
- 4. We were all enraptured with the _____ about the little girl and the red baboon
- 5. With her wide blue eyes and diffident smile, Carol was a natural for the _____ role.

6. The peace talks reached a(n) _____ when neither side would budge an inch since their last confrontation.
7. I can vouch for his _____ but not for his honesty.
8. The actor's _____ in his first film was followed by a disappointing series of failures.
9. Marie Antoinette set the pattern for women's _____ throughout the realm
10. President Carter's declaration that the feeling in the country was one of _____ was a faux pas that may have cost him a second term.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|---|-------|
| 1. failure | _____ |
| 2. settlement | _____ |
| 3. agitation | _____ |
| 4. sage | _____ |
| 5. well-being | _____ |
| 6. ennui | _____ |
| 7. a flop in business | _____ |
| 8. building events in a story to a climax | _____ |
| 9. a veteran actress who has seen better days | _____ |
| 10. a relatively unimpressive act | _____ |

Lesson 25

Crossword Puzzle Words

1. **acrid**: bitter; sharp; irritating to taste or smell
2. **addle**: to muddle; confuse. This word is often used in compounds of such as addlebrained
3. **ado**: fuss; trouble; bother
4. **alms**: money, food, or clothing given to poor people. Note the connection with elmsynary which means “charitable”
5. **amulet**: something worn around the neck as a protection against bad luck; a charm
6. **aperture**: opening; hole; gap.
7. **askew**: to one side; crooked
8. **bauble**: trinket; toy; showy but worthless thing. The Old French word bauble meant “toy”
9. **bevy**: group; flock. Bevy comes from an Old French word that meant “drinking group”
10. **bilk**: deceive; swindle; cheat. This word may be a corruption of balk, a term used in the card game of cribbage
11. **blithe**: light-hearted; joyful; cheerful. The Anglo-Saxon word blithia was used to describe a bright sky.
12. **careen**: to cause to lean sideways; to lurch or toss from side to side. The Latin word carina means “side of a ship”
13. **chary**: careful; cautious; shy. The Anglo-Saxon word cearig meant “sorrowful”
14. **nabob**: a very rich or influential man. A nabob was a native distinct ruler or a European who became very wealthy in India.
15. **onus**: task; burden; responsibility

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. An arm covered with costume jewelry

(addle, bauble, nabob)

2. Walking through the cemetery at night

(amulet, bilk, chary)

3. Peering into the camera lens

(onus, blithe, aperture)

4. A beggar on the streets of Calcutta

(alms, bevy, askew)

5. An angry crowd gathers to protest

(ado, careen, acrid)

6. A man abandons his family

(bilk, onus, careen)

7. A person of means

(nabob, amulet, chary)

8. Mutual recriminations

(chary, acrid, blithe)

9. Completely nonplussed

(addled, careen, askew)

10. A bauble fit for a king

(bevy, amulet, aperture)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- _____ 1. An expensive amulet is a bauble
- _____ 2. It's easy to be blithe when everything is going wrong.
- _____ 3. Addle-pated individuals are clear thinkers
- _____ 4. People are likely to seek favors and money from nabobs
- _____ 5. Saying good-bye to poverty is bidding a "farewell to aims"
- _____ 6. A blithe-spirited person is would tend to be optimistic
- _____ 7. Being bilked is usually a pleasant experience
- _____ 8. A bevy of thoughts dwell in the mind of a thinking person
- _____ 9. A careening car is probably out of control
- _____ 10. Collecting aims for the rich is hard to justify

Lesson 26

Mythology

1. **antaeon**: possessed of superhuman strength with suggestions of earthiness. Antaeus was an African giant, the son of Poseidon and Gaea, who was invincible while touching the ground, but was lifted into the air by Hercules and crushed.
2. **argonaut**: adventurer; one who sailed with Jason on the Argo in search of the Golden Fleece. Specifically, the word refers to a participant in the California Gold Rush of 1849
3. **calliope**: a musical instrument fitted with steam whistles, played from a keyboard, and usually heard at carnivals and circuses. It is named after Calliope, the Greek Muse of epic poetry.
4. **cyclopean**: vast, massive and rough; suggestive of the Cyclops, the race of one-eyed giants, descended from the Titans. One of the most exciting tales in the Odyssey recounts the blinding of the one-eyed Polyphemus, who had confined Odysseus' crew in his cave and promised to "reward" Odysseus by eating him first.
5. **gorgon**: a repulsively ugly or terrifying woman. In Greek mythology, the Gorgon sisters included the mortal Medusa, who had snakes for hair, and eyes that, if looked into, turned the beholder into stone.
6. **harpy**: a shrewish woman; a predatory person. The name is derived from the Harpies, one of several loathsome, voracious monsters, having a woman's head and trunk, and a bird's tail, wings, and talons.
7. **Homeric**: suggestive of Homer or his poetry; of heroic dimensions; grand; imposing.
8. **myrmidon**: a faithful follower who carries out orders without question. The Myrmidons were the legendary Greek warriors of ancient Thessaly who followed their king Achilles on the expedition against Troy.
9. **oracular**: uttered or delivered as if divinely inspired or infallible; ambiguous of obscure; portentous; ominous. Priests or priestesses in the shrines of ancient Greece would give ambiguous answers in response of a god to an inquiry. One famous shrine was the oracle of Apollo and Delphi.
10. **paean**: any song of praise, joy or triumph. In classical mythology a Paean was a god serving as a physician to the Olympian gods, later identified with Apollo.
11. **plutonian**: pertaining to the planet Pluto or the underworld; grim and gloomy; harsh and unpleasing. The Greek god of the subterranean world of the dead was Pluto, after whom our solar system's farthest planet was named.

12. **Promethean**: creative and boldly original. Prometheus was a Titan who taught mankind various arts and confined all its troubles in the box that Zeus treacherously gave to Epimetheus as the dowry of Pandora. For having stolen fire from Olympus and given to mankind in defiance of Zeus, Prometheus was chained to a rock where an eagle daily tore at his liver, until he was finally released by Hercules.

13. **stygian**: gloomy and dark; hellish; infernal; inviolable (safe from profanation). The river Styx was one of the rivers of Hades across which Charon ferried the souls of the dead.

14. **terpsichorean**: pertaining to dancing. Terpsichore was the Muse of dancing and choral and singing.

15. **thespian**: dramatic (adj.); an actor or actress (n.). Thespis was the Greek poet of the sixth century B.C. who was the reputed originator of tragic drama.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Music like a hundred steam whistles

(harpy, calliope, plutonian)

2. I would do anything you ask

(myrmidon, Homeric, paean)

3. Not recommended to give exact directions

(gorgon, Argonaut, oracular)

4. He is an outstanding dramatic actor

(terpsichorean, thespian, antaeon)

5. Beneficial to mankind

(cyclopean, stygian, Promethean)

6. A fighter is knocked down but raises himself with renewed strength

(stygian, thespian, antaeon)

7. A sweeping, best-selling novel

(cyclopean, Homeric, paean)

8. A song of victory

(paeon, Argonaut, gorgon)

9. A trip to the underworld

(harpy, stygian, thespian)

10. Dancing feet

(cyclopean, antaeon, terpsichorean)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

____ 1. Both stygian and plutonian have some association with gloom.

____ 2. A terpsichorean would be ideal for a comic role.

____ 3. An antaeon creature would relish being thrown to the earth

____ 4. Homeric laughter refers to the humorous passages in the Iliad and the Odyssey

____ 5. A calliope is a means of conveyance

____ 6. The first astronauts to the moon may be called Argonauts

____ 7. Harpy and gorgon refer specifically to women

____ 8. Myrmidons were faithful to their leader

____ 9. Both stygian and promethean are related to the Titans

____ 10. Antaeon, cyclopean, and promethean are connected to the giants in Greek

mythology.

III. Synonyms and Antonyms

Find and circle the two words in each line that are either synonyms or antonyms.

- | | | | |
|---------------|---------|------------|---------------|
| 1. harpy | musical | calliope | termagant |
| 2. gorgon | antaeon | obdurate | frail |
| 3. myrmidon | paeon | anguish | servant |
| 4. loquacious | awkward | oracular | terpsichorean |
| 5. puny | Homeric | infallible | graceful |

Lesson 27

Appearances and Attitudes

1. **pedantic**: stressing trivial points of learning; lacking a sense of proportion in scholarship. A pedant is a narrow-minded teacher who insists on rigid adherence to a set of arbitrary rules.
2. **pertinacious**: stubborn; unyielding; holding firmly to some belief.
3. **pontifical**: ornate; stiff; having the pomp and dignity of a high priest or Pope.
4. **pretentious**: making claims to some distinctions; showy. Pretentious people put on airs, try to appear more important than they are.
5. **prolix**: wordy; long-winded
6. **puerile**: childish; silly; young. In Latin it means “boy”
7. **quiescent**: inactive; in repose; latent
8. **recalcitrant**: unruly; refusing to obey authority. In Latin it meant “to kick one’s heels (calx) in defiance)
9. **restive**: hard to control; restless; contrary
10. **ribald**: coarse; vulgar in language; irreverent
11. **sardonic**: sarcastic; bitterly sneering. it is believed that this word can be traced back to a Sardinian plant whose bitter taste caused facial distortion
12. **sedulous**: busy; working hard; diligent
13. **sleazy**: flimsy or thin in texture or substance; of poor quality. This word can be traced back to cloth made in Silesia, Germany.
14. **supercilious**: naughty; arrogant; contemptuous
15. **voluptuous**: sensuous; full of sensual delights and pleasures

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A gangster's cruel smile

(puerile, sedulous, sardonic)

2. Second-rate fabric that wears poorly

(quiescent, pertinacious, sleazy)

3. Someone who uses a dozen words when one would do

(prolix, supercilious, recalcitrant)

4. The natives were nervous before the battle

(pontifical, restive, pretentious)

5. A night club comic's suggestive monologue

(pedantic, ribald, voluptuous)

6. A child who refuses to obey his parents and teachers

(puerile, recalcitrant, sedulous)

7. The actress's beauty rather than her talent was responsible for her popularity

(ribald, pertinacious, voluptuous)

8. Once Barry forms an opinion, he'll never change his mind

(pertinacious, pretentious, pontifical)

9. A trait that makes a person a success

(pedantic, sedulous, supercilious)

10. Someone follows the rules but misses the spirit

(pontifical, pedantic, quiescent)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- _____ 1. Mules and oxen are frequently described as being pertinacious
- _____ 2. Sleazy products deserve the high price they command
- _____ 3. Gary Cooper, famed for using words sparingly drew compliments for that prolix style.
- _____ 4. Although we strive to be young, no one wants to be described as puerile
- _____ 5. Quiescent talent can often be brought to the surface through patient teaching techniques
- _____ 6. Puerile behavior is not likely to win you friends
- _____ 7. The defendant was acquitted because of his sleazy background
- _____ 8. A restive person would appreciate frequent periods of silence.
- _____ 9. Being puerile, Brenda often does not act her age
- _____ 10. The voluptuous figures in the museum attracted the attention of the crowd

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. Joanna, finding it difficult to tolerate the _____ attitude of the salespeople in the exclusive boutique, left without buying anything
- 2. The unscrupulous travel agent tried to sell the mystery trip as an adventure that would contain many _____ experiences
- 3. Realizing he was losing friends because of his _____ airs, Martin vowed to stop being showy.
- 4. The _____ character of the two rivals prolonged the argument; neither would budge an inch
- 5. Defending his _____ style, Professor Dobbins claimed he had written the book for scholars like himself.
- 6. The teacher advised the class not to adopt a(n) _____ tone in a letter of application
- 7. Jerry actually drove his customers away with his _____ sales pitch.

8. The valedictorian was careful to keep _____ expressions out of her speech
9. Parents wait for the day when their children will be as _____ in fulfilling their family responsibilities as they are in preparing for a party.
10. There is a time for fun and revelry, but that does not include an overdoes of _____ speech.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provide?

- | | |
|---------------|-------|
| 1. indolent | _____ |
| 2. mature | _____ |
| 3. terse | _____ |
| 4. docile | _____ |
| 5. refined | _____ |
| 6. dynamic | _____ |
| 7. docile | _____ |
| 8. unassuming | _____ |
| 9. austere | _____ |
| 10. concise | _____ |

Lesson 28

Foreign Terms

1. **a cappella**: without instrumental accompaniment. Usually used to describe choral singing. In Italian, the meaning is “in the chapel style”
2. **ad hoc**: for this case only; temporary. The most frequent use of this Latin term is to describe a committee that is organized to deal with a specific issue and will be disbanded later.
3. **bon vivant**: one who enjoys good food and other pleasant things.
4. **de facto**: in fact; actual. The law may require one thing (de jure), but as a matter of fact (de facto) the reality is quite different.
5. **gemutlich**: agreeable; cheerful. This German word is often used to describe a sense of well being.
6. **leitmotif**: a short musical phrase that recurs and is associated with a given character, situation, or emotion in an opera. This technique was first used by the German composer, Richard Wagner.
7. **nolo contendere**: a defendant’s plea declaring that he will not make a defense but not admitting hit guilt.
8. **per excellence**: in the greatest degree of excellence. This French term also means “beyond comparison”
9. **parvenu**: one who has suddenly acquired wealth or power; a person who is considered an upstart because he does not conform to the standards of the class into which he has risen. This word has the same “put down” connotation as “nouveau riche”
10. **piece de resistance**: the principal dish of a meal; the main item or event in a series.
11. **postprandial**: after dinner. In Latin prandium means “noonday meal”
12. **quid pro quo**: one thing in return for another
13. **qui vive**: to be on the lookout or on the alert is to be on the qui vive. The literal French meaning is “who lives?” or “who goes there?” and, as such, was a term used by sentries.
14. **savoir faire**: a ready knowledge of what to do or say; tact.

15. **sub rosa**: secretly; confidentially. In Latin, “under the rose” The rose was a symbol of silence or secrecy in ancient times.

16. **vis-à-vis**: a person or thing that is face to face with another opposite; in reference to; opposed to.

Exercises:

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A person who enjoys good food and one wine

(bon vivant, postprandial, piece de resistance)

2. A group of citizens form a committee to beautify their town.

(a cappella, qui vive, ad hoc)

3. In court, the defendant rises to plead

(nolo contendere, parvenu, de facto)

4. Every time the camera switches to the cavalry, trumpets are heard

(par excellence, leitmotif, sub rosa)

5. You are asked to repay a favor

(savoir faire, quid pro quo, gemütlich)

6. Though the general was not voted in he was, in fact, the leader of their country

(bon vivant, de facto, sub rosa)

7. As expected, when the songstress appeared on stage, the strains in her latest hit wafted across the packed theater.

(leitmotif, savoir faire, par excellence)

8. Charles knew just what to say to cover up his slip of the lip

(qui vive, parvenu, savoir faire)

9. The amateur boxer was quite cheerful after scoring a first round KO

(gemutlich, postprandial, vis-à-vis)

10. Ronald's deep baritone was so compelling, we did not miss the absence of the musical accompaniment

(piece de resistance, a capella, bon vivant)

II. True or False ?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- ___ 1. Publication of a sub rosa agreement can prove embarrassing.
- ___ 2. An opportunist may be described as one who is on the qui vive.
- ___ 3. Minority groups are likely to protest about de facto segregation.
- ___ 4. In her a cappella performance, the star criticized her accompanist
- ___ 5. Sophisticated people are expected to possess savoir faire
- ___ 6. Being in a gemutlich mood, Kate enjoyed the comedian's "bring-down-the-house" monologue
- ___ 7. The weightiest problems are sometimes solved by ad hoc committees
- ___ 8. The piece de resistance of the program, the fireworks display, naturally drew the greatest applause
- ___ 9. Henry's qui vive was a big factor in his political downfall.
- ___ 10. Coping with his status as a parvenu was more difficult for Scoot than the poverty he endured before striking it rich.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. The lawyer suggested a(n) _____ plea as the most prudent way to deal with the charges against his client.
- 2. The commissioner's response to the question _____ his exorbitant travel expenses was a flat denial

3. During the long illness of the leader; the country was in a(n) _____ state of anarchy.
4. One has to admit that singing _____ places a greater strain on the performer.
5. The Congressional Medal of Honor is bestowed upon the soldier _____ who has demonstrated consummate bravery
6. The best way to get things done is a deal with problems on a(n) _____ basis.
7. When a _____ meets a hedonist you can bet the conversation will center around good food and good times.
8. Gary learned very quickly that _____ was the rule in politics.
9. Saddam Hussein claimed he had destroyed all his biological and nuclear weapons, but the _____ situation was quite different.
10. Rosa's presence made everyone feel _____ and ready to enjoy the evening with friends.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

1. grouch _____
2. offensive _____
3. publicly _____
4. permanent _____
5. tactlessness _____
6. blundering _____
7. inferior _____
8. ascetic _____
9. public _____
10. trivial _____

Lesson 29

Appearances and Attitudes

1. **ambivalent**: having conflicting feelings toward a person or thing, such as love and hate
2. **bucolic**: rural; rustic; pastoral. The Greek word boukolikos means “herdsman”
3. **crotchety**: full of peculiar whims; ill-tempered; eccentric. Crochet work was done with a small, twisted hook; from “twisted” it was an easy jump to “eccentric” –thus the connection between crochet and crotchety
4. **dilatory**: slow; late in doing things; inclined to delay; meant to gain time
5. **disconsolate**: sad; dejected; cheerless
6. **dudgeon**: resentment; an angry or offended feeling. It comes from the Anglo-French expression en digeon, which meant “the hand on the dagger hilt”
7. **froward**: contrary; not easily controlled; stubbornly willful
8. **genteel**: well bred; refined; excessively polite
9. **jocund**: pleasant; agreeable; genial. Our word joke can be traced back to jocund.
10. **loquacious**: talkative. Some synonyms are garrulous, voluble, prolix, verbose, and prating.
11. **splenetic**: irritable; bad-tempered; spiteful. The word derives from spleen, the abdominal organ that the ancients regarded as the seat of emotions
12. **tendentious**: opinionated; advancing a definite point of view or doctrine
13. **truculent**: fierce; cruel; savage
14. **vacuous**: empty; purposeless; stupid; senseless
15. **venal**: really bribed or corrupted

Exercises

I. Which Word comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. Cows in meadow, sheep in the corn

(venal, bucolic, disconsolate)

2. First, I want to go-then I want to stay

(ambivalent, truculent, dudgeon)

3. “What’s your rush? So what if we’re late?”

(jocund, dilatory, genteel)

4. The millionaire asked to be buried in his Rolls Royce

(crotchety, tendentious, froward)

5. “Were you vaccinated with a phonograph needle?”

(vacuous, loquacious, splenetic)

6. Jane always has a smile on her face

(froward, venal, jocund)

7. Firing someone can easily put him/her into this frame of mind

(dudgeon, tendentious, bucolic)

8. The slightest remark sets Virginia off on a rampage

(truculent, splenetic, dilatory)

9. I can’t make up my mind

(crotchety, ambivalent, tendentious)

10. A decidedly partisan view of the inaugural address

(genteel, splenetic, tendentious)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- _____ 1. A jocund person has a good chance of being hired as a receptionist
- _____ 2. Splenetic behavior is always a sign of good breeding
- _____ 3. Truly great bullfighters welcome an animal that is froward
- _____ 4. Watergate has become synonomous with venal arrangements
- _____ 5. Skyscrapers and subways are integral parts of the bucolic life
- _____ 6. Greg's genteel nature may account for his shyness
- _____ 7. A truculent response is guaranteed to win friends.
- _____ 8. Feeling disconsolate over his loss, Fred briefly considered retiring from baseball.
- _____ 9. The student's vacuous stare suggested he did not understand the question
- _____ 10. Because of his loquacious nature. Carlos had little to say.

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below.

- 1. Martha wondered how Gary could hope to convince her with such _____ explanations
- 2. The successful politician walks a thin line between appearing too _____ and too wishy-washy.
- 3. Stephan tired to sort out his _____ feelings of respect and resentment towards his father.
- 4. After the hectic campaign, the president-elect was refreshed by his _____ retreat
- 5. A(n) _____ child perhaps needs more love than a well-adjusted one
- 6. The _____ life has its merits, but most people cannot resist the attractions and excitement of the city.
- 7. A _____ person tends to give others little opportunity to express themselves.

8. The fans were deeply disappointed to learn that their idol had been bitten by the _____ bug
9. The _____ host easily broke the iciness between two of the guests who had been enemies for years.
10. Because of George's _____ habits, we often referred to him as the late George Owens.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|------------------|-------|
| 1. punctual | _____ |
| 2. gentle | _____ |
| 3. even-tempered | _____ |
| 4. gross | _____ |
| 5. incorruptible | _____ |
| 6. agreeable | _____ |
| 7. cheerful | _____ |
| 8. unequivocal | _____ |
| 9. urban | _____ |
| 10. intelligent | _____ |

Lesson 30

Size and Shape

1. **amorphous:** without definite form; shapeless
2. **gargantuan:** huge; gigantic; prodigious. The word comes from Rabelais sixteenth-century political satire, Gargantua and Pantagruel
3. **iota:** very small quantity; a jot. iota is the ninth letter of the Greek alphabet
4. **lissome:** supple; limber; flexible
5. **macrocosm:** the great world; the universe. The opposite of this is microcosm
6. **magnitude:** greatness of size or extent; importance of influence
7. **magnum opus:** a great work, especially of art or literature
8. **microcosm:** a little world; miniature universe. It is the opposite of macrocosm.
9. **micrometer:** an instrument for measuring very small distance, angles, diameters. In Latin, micro means small and meter means to measure.
10. **scabrous:** rough with small points or knobs; bumpy; scaly; full of difficulties. In Latin, scabere means “to scratch”
11. **scintilla:** the least trace; a particle. In Latin, scintilla means “a spark”
12. **serpentine:** evilly cunning or subtle; treacherous; coiled; twisting.
13. **sinuous:** bending; wavy. The word sinus (“a cavity in the bones of the skull”) is related to sinuous.
14. **smidgen:** a small amount; a bit. This word is related to “midge” or midget.
15. **tenuous:** unsubstantial; flimsy; physically thin.

Exercises

I. Which word comes to mind?

In each of the following, read the statement then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A writer spends ten years preparing his masterpiece.

(macrocosm, magnum opus, micrometer)

2. Cyclops had an enormous appetite

(scintilla, gargantuan, microcosm)

3. A graceful gymnast

(lissome, smidgen, iota)

4. An indefinite proposal

(serpentine, scabrous, tenuous)

5. The actress adopted a sexy walk

(amorphous, magnitude, sinuous)

6. A doctor carefully measures the size of the tumor

(amorphous, micrometer, scabrous)

7. The overthrow of the government began with the act of treachery

(serpentine, scabrous, lissome)

8. An insignificant amount

(sinuous, scintilla, gargantuan)

9. A face knotted with bumps and rough spots

(amorphous, tenuous, scabrous)

10. A trace of seasoning

(microcosm, smidgen, magnum opus)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false?

- _____ 1. The microcosm of the man reflects the macrocosm of the universe
- _____ 2. The magnitude of the Grand Canyon frequently awes travelers
- _____ 3. A tenuous idea is often offered hesitantly
- _____ 4. Two words in this lesson that are closely related are smidgen and iota
- _____ 5. The amorphous scheme was spelled out in such detail that it was grasped by all
- _____ 6. The scabrous surface reminded one of the shiny smoothness of a marble table
- _____ 7. The million dollar gift exemplified his gargantuan kindness
- _____ 8. The lissome ballerina glided through her performance with unparalleled grace
- _____ 9. Fielding's Joseph Andrews was his magnum opus.
- _____ 10. Frank's tenuous explanation was hardly enough to justify his outburst

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. Because of the _____ of the offense, the judge set a high bail
- 2. Space exploration advances suggest that our civilization has developed in a very limited _____.
- 3. Mr. Ludwig would not admit that his business success had been achieved through _____ tactics
- 4. The race was so close it would take a(n) _____ to measure who was the winner
- 5. Margaret Mitchell's _____ *Gone With the Wind* was her only book
- 6. There was not a _____ of truth to the accusation
- 7. The team had a(n) _____ hold on first place until a rash of injuries sent them reeling.
- 8. The commencement speaker told the graduates that the road to success is full of _____ turns.
- 9. Cleaning up after the parade proved to be a _____ task.

10. The strange creature we found on the beach was so _____, we could not identify its species.

IV. What's the Antonym?

Which of the new words is most nearly the opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|---------------------|-------|
| 1. sturdy | _____ |
| 2. diminutive | _____ |
| 3. smooth | _____ |
| 4. having form | _____ |
| 5. wooden | _____ |
| 6. straight | _____ |
| 7. inflexible | _____ |
| 8. insignificance | _____ |
| 9. universe | _____ |
| 10. amateur attempt | _____ |

Lesson 31

Language

1. **bathos**: anticlimax; triteness or triviality in style; sentimentality. Bathos is also used to denote an insincere pathos, an evocation of pity or compassion.

2. **malapropism**: ridiculous misuse of words, especially by confusion of words that are similar in sound. Mrs. Malaprop, a character in Sheridan's famous Restoration play. *The Rivals*, is noted for her misapplication of words

3. **metaphor**: the application of a word or phrase to an object or concept that it does not literally denote, in order to suggest a comparison with another object or concept. The use of metaphors may help to clarify or ennoble an idea, but one must not mix metaphors. This practice results in humorous effects, such as "We must put our noses to the grindstone and push."

4. **metonymy**: the use of the name of one object or concept for that of another to which it is related, or of which it is a part, as "the bottle" for strong drink.

5. **onomatopoeia**: formation of words in imitation of natural sounds; the use of words whose sound suggests the sense. The "bow-wow theory" of language maintains the language that originated in imitation of natural sounds; the use of words whose sound suggest the sense. By contrast, the "pooh-pooh theory" says language originated in interjections that gradually acquired meaning.

6. **oxymoron**: a figure of speech by which a particular phrasing of words produces an effect by seeing self-contradiction, as in "cruel kindness" or "laborious idleness." The Greek meaning is "pointed foolishness"

7. **panegyric**: an oration, discourse, or writing in praise of a person or thing; eulogy

8. **paradigm**: example or pattern; a set of forms in grammar all of which contain a particular element, especially the set of all inflected forms based on a single stem (as in verb declensions)

9. **paralipsis**: the suggestion, by deliberately concise treatment of a topic; that much significant material is being omitted, as in the use of the phrase "not to mention other faults." Another name for paralipsis is preterition.

10. **pleonasm**: the use of more words than necessary to express an idea; redundancy; superfluity. It is derived from the Greek word for "to be or have more than enough"

11. **polyglot**: knowing many or several languages; containing, composed of, or in several languages; a confusion of languages; a person with a speaking or reading knowledge of a

number of languages; a book, especially a Bible, containing the same text in several languages.

12. **semantics**: the study of meaning; the study of linguistic development by classifying and examining changes in meaning and form. Semantics is also called signifiici, a branch of semiotics (signs and symbols) dealing with the relationship between signs and what they denote. General semantics is an educational discipline concerning the relationships between symbols and reality and with improving the adjustment of people to each other and to the environment.

13. **simile**: a figure of speech in which two unlike things are explicitly compared using the words “like” or “as” as in “she is like a rose”

14. **synecdoche**: a figure of speech in which a part is used for a while or the whole for a part, the special for the general or the general for the special, as in “ten sail” for “ten ships” or a Croesus for a “rich man” or the name of the material for the thing made (“willow” for “bat”)

15. **threnody**: a poem, speech, or slang of lamentation, especially of the dead; dirge; funeral song.

Exercises

Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following read the statement then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. She was too young to die

(polyglot, simile, threnody)

2. The allegories on the banks of the Nile

(malapropism, metonymy, synecodoche)

3. Snap! Crackle! Pop!

(paradigm, oxymoron, onomatopoeia)

4. A true fact

(bathos, pleonasm, semantics)

5. The least of his crimes is his complicity with drugs

(metaphor, panegyric, paralipsis)

6. Jack answered the insult by saying, “I resemble that remark”

(bathos, malapropism, oxymoron)

7. Napoleon is credited with saying “From the sublime to the ridiculous it is but one step”

(panegyric, metonymy, bathos)

8. He was a lion in battle

(simile, metaphor, paralipsis)

9. Our guest spoke seven languages

(paradigm, pleonasm, polyglot)

10. The pot calling the kettle black

(semantics, synecdoche, threnody)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. Both metaphor and simile use forms of comparison
- ____ 2. Synecdoche and metonymy are similar figures of speech in which an object or idea is describing reference to only a part of it.
- ____ 3. A polyglot is a person with a taste for exotic foods
- ____ 4. Semantics is concerned with the syntax of a language.
- ____ 5. A panegyric is a test devised to determine the linguistic level of a speaker.
- ____ 6. Paradigm and paragon both refer to an example.
- ____ 7. Every simile uses the words “like” or “as”
- ____ 8. Onomatopoeia refers to a group of words beginning with the same consonant
- ____ 9. Bathos is the sudden change in style producing a ludicrous effect
- ____ 10. This sentence illustrates, demonstrates, and exemplifies a pleonasm.

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three.

- | | | | |
|----------------|-----------|----------|-------------|
| 1. metaphor | simile | literary | comparative |
| 2. threnody | legacy | elegy | dirge |
| 3. encomium | panegyric | panorama | accolade |
| 4. paradox | paradigm | paragon | touchstone |
| 5. insinuation | intuition | innuendo | paralipsis |

Lesson 32

Speech

1. **argot**: the specialized vocabulary and idioms of those in the same work or way of life, especially of the underworld. The French origin, meaning “to beg” associated beggary with thievery.
2. **aspersion**: act of defaming; a damaging or disparaging remark; a sprinkling of water, as in baptizing. This final definition, now rare, is based on an archaic meaning of the original Latin word for “sprinkle” The modern definition refers to “sprinkling” a few maliciously chosen words to vilify someone.
3. **badinage**: playful, teasing talk, banter
4. **bombast**: originally a soft material used for padding, talk or writing the sounds grand or important but has little meaning; pompous language. Bombastic refers to speech or writing that is heavily padded with words; grandiloquent suggests grandiose language and an oratorical effect; turgid suggests the style has obscured the meaning.
5. **braggadocio**: a braggart; pretentiousness; vain, noisy, or bragging swaggering manner. The word was coined by Edmund Spenser for his personification of boasting in the “Faerie Queena”
6. **censure**: strong disapproval; a judgement or resolution condemning a person for misconduct.
7. **countermand**: to cancel or revoke a command; to call back by a contrary order
8. **gainsay**: to deny; to speak or act against contradiction; denial
9. **gobbledegook**: wordy and generally unintelligible jargon; specialized language of a group of people that is usually wordy and complicated and often incomprehensible to an outsider; a meaningless jumble of words.
10. **guttural**: of the throat, a harsh, rasping sound.
11. **harangue**: a long, blustering, noisy, or scolding speech, tirade. The original Italian word meant “a site for horse races and public assemblies.
12. **jargon**: a language or dialect unknown to one so that it seems incomprehensible; a mixed or hybrid language or dialect, especially pidgin, specialized idioms of those in the same work, profession, speech or writing full of long, unfamiliar; or roundabout words or phrases. The Middle French root means “a chattering of birds” The word is ultimately of echoic origin.

13. **mellifluous**: sounding sweet and smooth, honeyed

14. **resonant**: echoing, reinforced and prolonged by reflection or by sympathetic vibration of other bodies. The word has specialized uses in various fields-chemistry, electricity, medicine, phonetics, physics.

15. **sententious**: abounding in pithy aphorisms or maxims; terse; self-righteous.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to the end.

1. Spots lingo

(harangue, jargon, resonant)

2. A snide remark

(countermand, badinage, aspersion)

3. Coughing sound

(gobbledegook, guttural, censure)

4. Sweet-sounding talk

(mellifluous, sententious, bombast)

5. A thousand times no!

(braggadocio, argot, gainsay)

6. How the rejected suitor concealed the sorrow in his heart

(gainsay, badinage, harangue)

7. The opera star shook the room with his voice

(resonant, braggadocio, mellifluous)

8. A 180-degree turnaround.

(gobbledegook, argot, countermand)

9. Frank's threats are not as frightening as the sound

(aspersion, bombast, censure)

10. An incomprehensible language

(argon, sententious, guttural)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- ____ 1. Argot and jargon have one meaning in common
- ____ 2. Bombast may be a cover for weak content
- ____ 3. Countermanding is equivalent to sticking to your guns.
- ____ 4. Sententious is more concerned with sense than sound.
- ____ 5. Badinage is a minor vice that indicates immaturity
- ____ 6. A harangue is likely to be full of bombast
- ____ 7. Censure refers to a firm belief in a theory under discussion
- ____ 8. Gobbledegook is a language that attempts imitate bird sounds
- ____ 9. Guttural speech is socially unacceptable
- ____ 10. Observing the size and strength of his opponent, Mark was wise not to gainsay his assertions.

III. Synonyms and Antonyms

Find and circle two words on each line that are either synonyms or antonyms.

- | | | | |
|------------------|------------|-------------|------------|
| 1. glorification | release | aspersion | dismay |
| 2. mellifluous | ethos | attitude | soft |
| 3. timidity | paranoid | braggadocio | freedom |
| 4. plebescite | gainsay | votary | deny |
| 5. rhapsodic | peccadillo | falsetto | bombastic. |

Lesson 33

History and Government

1. **canon:** an ecclesiastical or secular law or code of laws; a basis for judgment; any officially recognized set of books. Canon has many specialized meanings in religion and in literature referring to the authoritative list of accepted books.
2. **hegemony:** leadership; preponderant influence or authority, especially of a government or state.
3. **oligarchy:** form of government in which the ruling power lies in the hands of a select few
4. **peonage:** a system by which debtors are bound in servitude to their creditors until debts are paid; the condition of being an unskilled day laborer, especially in Latin America and the southwestern United States. The word peon ultimately is traceable to the Latin word for “walker” and therefore also developed a meaning of “foot soldier”
5. **pharisaical:** making an outward show of piety but lacking the inward spirit; hypocritical. Originally, Pharisaism referred to the doctrine and practices of the Pharisees, the Hebrew sect that followed the path of withdrawal, separation, and dedication and became the mainstream of Jewish belief. Later Christological history gave the word a negative connotation.
6. **plebiscite:** a direct vote of the qualified electors of a state in regard to some important public question. The word is derived from the Latin words *plebes scitum* (“the people’s decree”)
7. **plenipotentiary:** invested with or conferring full power; a diplomatic agent fully authorized to represent his government.
8. **proxy:** an agent or substitute; a document giving one authority to act for another.
9. **recession:** the act of withdrawing or going back; a moderate and temporary decline in economic activity that occurs during a period of otherwise increasing prosperity.
10. **regicide:** the killing of a king; one who kills or helps to kill a king.
11. **renascent:** coming into being again; showing renewed growth or vigor. The word is related to Renaissance, the humanistic revival of classical art, literature and learning that originated in Italy in the fourteenth century and later spread throughout Europe.
12. **reprisal:** the practice of using political or military force without actually resorting to war; retaliation for an injury with the intent of inflicting at least as much injury in return

13. **subversion**: ruination or complete destruction; corruption; complete overthrow. As the meaning implied, the original Latin word meant “to turn upside down”

14. **surrogate**: a substitute; in some states, a judge having jurisdiction over the probate of wills and the settlement of estates. As a verb, the word means “to substitute or to put into the place of another”

15. **votary**: a person bound by vows to live a life of religious worship and service, as a monk or nun; any person fervently devoted to a religion, activity, or ideal.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. Sharecroppers or migrant workers

(surrogate, proxy, peonage)

2. You can't judge a book by its cover

(pharisaical, reprisal, renascent)

3. Vox populi

(votary, plebiscite, subversion)

4. A man to be reckoned with

(regicide, canon, plenipotentiary)

5. Times are bad but they could be worse

(oligarchy, recession, hegemony)

6. Holier than thou

(surrogate, canon, regicide)

7. Tit for tat

(proxy, subversion, reprisal)

8. A commitment for life

(votary, renascent, oligarchy)

9. Who's the boss?

(peonage, hegemony, surrogate)

10. A second chance

(proxy, renascent, surrogate)

II. True or False

In the space provide, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. Hegemony refers to the currency of circulation
- ____ 2. A proxy and a surrogate are similar, both suggesting a substitute
- ____ 3. A votary is one who keeps his word
- ____ 4. A regicide favors the restoration of a monarchy
- ____ 5. Vengeance is an act of reprisal
- ____ 6. In an oligarchy everyone has an equal share in the government
- ____ 7. The word "pharisaical" has acquired a derogatory connotation.
- ____ 8. Subversion is an attempt to change the system that is now in place
- ____ 9. Working under peonage is a good way to build a future in government.
- ____ 10. In a plebiscite the people exercise their right of self-determination

Lesson 34

Travel

1. **antipodal**: on the opposite side of the globe; diametrically opposite
2. **cartography**: art or business of drawing or making charts or maps. The original meaning of chart was a map for the use of navigation indicating the outline of coasts, position of rocks, sandbanks, and channels.
3. **concierge**: doorkeeper; caretaker; custodian; janitor. The concierge in French and other European hotels has a more important position than is implied by the title of janitor or custodian
4. **hegira**: any flight or journey to a more desirable or congenial place than where one is. Hegira was the flight of Muhammad from Mecca to Medina to escape persecution in 622 A.D., a date regarded as the beginning of the Muslim era.
5. **hustings**: the route followed by a campaigner for political office; an election platform; the proceedings at an election. The original Old English word referred to a lord's household assembly as distinct from a general assembly.
6. **landmark**: any fixed object used to mark the boundary of a piece of land; any prominent feature of the landscape, serving to identify a particular locality; an event or discovery considered as a high point or a turning point in the history of development of something.
7. **peripatetic**: moving from place to place; itinerant; of the followers of Aristotle, who walked about the lyceum while he was teaching
8. **portmanteau**: a case or bag to carry clothing while traveling, especially a leather trunk or suitcase that opens into two halves. The literal French meaning is "cloak carrier" A more recent use of the word in linguistics is to define a blend, a word made by putting together parts of other words, as dandle, made from dance and handle.
9. **safari**: a journey or hunting expedition, especially in East Africa; the caravan of such an expedition; a long, carefully planned trip, usually with a large entourage.
10. **tandem**: a two-wheeled carriage drawn by horses harnessed one behind the other; a bicycle with two seats and sets of pedals placed one behind the other; a relationship between two persons or things involving cooperative action and mutual dependence. Tandem may be a noun, an adjective, or an adverb.
11. **transmigrate**: to move from one habitation or country to another; in religion, to pass into some other body at death (of the soul). Believers in reincarnation and

metempsychosis also feel that the souls of the dead successively return to earth in new forms and bodies.

12. **traverse**: to pass, move, or extend over or across; oppose; to survey or inspect carefully; to swivel or pivot; to move across a mountain slope in an oblique direction (as in skiing); a zigzagging course.

13. **trek**: to travel by ox wagon; to travel slowly or laboriously. Colloquially the word means “to go, especially on foot.” Trek is also used as a noun.

14. **wanderlust**: an impulse, longing, or urge to have or wander.

15. **wayfarer**: a person who travels, especially from place to place on foot.

Exercises:

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. A train makes whistle-stops across the Midwest

(trek, hustings, hegira)

2. Infanticide, slithy, swalm

(peripatetic, concierge, portmanteau)

3. The Supreme Court decision on school integration

(cartography, landmark, antipodal)

4. Tracking lions in their native habitat

(safari, wayfarer, wanderlust)

5. A bicycle built for two

(transmigrate, tandem, traversel)

6. In total disagreement

(traverse, tandem, antipodal)

7. the annual trip to a summer residence

(landmark, safari, hegira)

8. The “feel of flesh” aspect of electioneering

(wayfarer, hustings, trek)

9. Miles to go before I sleep

(traverse, peripatetic, transmigrate)

10. Take only what is necessary

(tandem, trek, portmanteau)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false?

- ___ 1. A safari can properly be described as a trek through the jungle
- ___ 2. The art of cartography has proved to be helpful for navigators.
- ___ 3. The early Peripatetics were philosophers
- ___ 4. Transmigration is a form of ESP
- ___ 5. Wanderlust describes the sensuality of the homeless criminal.
- ___ 6. Gaining the good will of the concierge can prove very helpful for a detective
- ___ 7. People who see eye to eye for the most part are said to be antipodal
- ___ 8. Transmigration can refer to movements of the soul as well as of the body
- ___ 9. Broadly speaking, cartography includes traveling by wagon, car, train, or plane
- ___ 10. The handshake of the former enemies was considered a landmark gesture.

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three.

- | | | | |
|----------------|-----------|----------------|------------|
| 1. peripatetic | hegira | globe-trotting | parabolic |
| 2. vagabondage | wayfarer | valediction | nomadism |
| 3. tirade | trek | harangue | diatribe |
| 4. astronaut | travail | navigator | pilgrim |
| 5. anticipate | antipodal | different | antithetic |

Lesson 35

Foods and Taste

1. a la carte: by the card or by the bill of fare. It is used to describe a meal that is ordered dish by dish, with each dish having a separate price. The opposite table d'hôte, a complete meal of several courses offered at a fixed price.
2. assuage: to satisfy and slake; to lessen (pain or distress; anger; calm (passion); relieve. The Latin root *suavis* ("sweet") suggests that sweets play an important role in our eating habits
3. comestible: suitable to be eaten. The plural, comestibles, is used as a noun and means "food"
4. condiment: seasoning or relish for food, such as pepper, mustard, or sauce. The Latin root means "to pickle"
5. cuisine: style of cooking or preparing food; the food prepared, as at a restaurant. In French it means "kitchen"
6. culinary: of the kitchen or cooking; suitable for use in cooking. Culinary comes from the Latin word for "kitchen" or "*culina*," *culina*.
7. gastronomic: pertaining to the art and science of good eating; epicurean; pertaining to the enjoyment of food with a discriminating taste. *Gaster* is the Greek word for "stomach" *Gastronome* is the Russian name for a delicatessen.
8. gourmand: a glutton; a person with a hearty liking for good food and drink and a tendency to indulge in them to excess; a luxurious eater or epicure. Gourmet has only the second meaning, that is, a connoisseur in eating and drinking.
9. manna: food miraculously provided for the Israelites in the wilderness; divine and spiritual sustenance; anything badly needed that comes unexpectedly.
10. palatable: pleasing or acceptable to the taste; acceptable to the mind.
11. piquant: agreeably pungent or stimulating to the taste, pleasantly sharp or bitter; exciting agreeable interest or curiosity; stimulating.
12. refection: refreshment, especially with food or drink. Refection comes from a Latin word meaning "to restore" and refers to a light meal taken after a period of hunger or fatigue.

13. repast: a meal; mealtime. Like other words in this list, repast has nonmaterialistic association as well. Pastor for example is derived from the same Latin word pascere meaning “to feed”

14. subsistence: existence; means of support or livelihood, often the barest.

15. viands: foods of various kinds, especially choice dishes, ultimate root is the Latin vivere, “to live”

Exercises:

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind

1. Catsup, curry, vinegar

(a la carte, refectory, condiment)

2. Pennies from heaven

(cuisine, manna, gourmand)

3. Living on the edge of poverty

(subsistence, assuage, gastronomic)

4. Wake-up flavor

(repast, comestibles, piquant)

5. “Something’s cooking”

(culinary, palatable, viands)

6. Oranges and fruit cakes

(condiments, comestible, manna)

7. Italian, French, and Chinese

(a la carte, subsistence, cuisine)

8. He eats as if food is going out of style

(gastronomic, gourmand, viands)

9. The minister speaking to the grieving widow

(assuage, a la carte, refection)

10. Refers to ways of serving

(condiment, a la carte, palatable)

II. True or False ?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false ?

_____ 1. A la carte refers to food brought to the table in a wagon.

_____ 2. Assuage refers to both hunger and thirst

_____ 3. Gourmand can be used with a complimentary or derogatory connotation

_____ 4. Palatable applies to foods that can be served on a plate

_____ 5. Gastronomic describes a condition caused by excessive indulgence in foods that are rich in fats and carbohydrates

_____ 6. Viands refer to choice dishes

_____ 7. A la carte refers to payment for food rather than to types of food

_____ 8. Both gourmet and gourmand describe good connoisseurs

_____ 9. A repast is a snack; reflection is a full meal.

_____ 10. The expression “Men does not live by bread alone” suggests that things other than food are palatable.

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three

- | | | | |
|---------------|-------------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. comestible | edifying | esculent | estable |
| 2. slake | assuage | determine | sate |
| 3. sustenance | substinence | essential | aliment |
| 4. palatable | pungent | toothsome | agreeable |
| 5. banquet | refection | repeat | relish |

Lesson 36

Fun and Frolic

1. **antic**: odd and funny; ludicrous; a playful or silly act, trick, prank or caper. Shakespeare has Hamlet hide his real intent by assuming an antic disposition.
2. **beguile**: to charm; to divert attention in some pleasant way; to while away; to deceive.
3. **bonhomie**: frank and simple good-heartedness; a good-natured manner. The word is a combination of two French words meaning “good” and “man.” Bonhomie was the name given in order of begging friars and finally to French peasants in general.
4. **dalliance**: a trifling away of time; amorous toying; flirtation. In Hamlet, Ophelia reminds her brother Laertes not to give her moral advice while he follows “the primrose path of dalliance”
5. **divertissement**: a diversion or amusement; a short belief or other entertainment performed between the acts of a play.
6. **euphoria**: a feeling of well-being or high spirits, especially one that is groundless, disproportionate to its cause, or inappropriate to one’s life situation.
7. **guffaw**: a loud, coarse burst of laughter. This is an echoic onomatopoeic word. Laughs range from chuckles, giggles, and titters to snickers and guffaws
8. **insouciance**: calmness; freedom from anxiety; indifference
9. **japery**: jesting talk; mockery; a trick or practical joke
10. **regale**: to entertain by providing a splendid feast; to delight with something pleasing or amusing. The first meaning is related etymologically to the word regal, as it was customary for a king to treat his courtiers to sumptuous feasts.
11. **risible**: able or inclined to laugh; laughable; funny. Most people are familiar with Leoncavallo’s opera. Pagilacci, in which the major character sings “Ride, Pagilacci.” Our word ridiculous shows the close relationship to risible.
12. **roguish**: dishonest; unprincipled; pleasantly mischevious.
13. **roister**: to boast or swagger; to have a noisy; disorderly good time, especially under the influence of alcohol. This word can be traced to rustic and rural, indicating the low esteem in which the country ruffian and boor was held by the sophisticated city dweller.
14. **squib**: a firecracker that burns with a hissing, spurting noise before exploding; a short, humorous satiric writing or speech; a short news item or filler.

15. **waggish**: roguishly merry, playful.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle that comes to mind.

1. A pleasant intermission

(insouciance, divertissement, roister)

2. The laughter of the jolly green giant

(guffaw, euphoria, dalliance)

3. A ten-course banquet

(japery, regale, risible)

4. Racy humor

(bonhomie, waggish, beguile)

5. A satire

(antic, roguish, squib)

6. Laughing at the breakup of the marriage

(divertissement, insouciance, euphoria)

7. Honest, I was just kidding

(japery, regale, guffaw)

8. The morning-after hangover

(risible, roguish, roister)

9. A true friend

(bonhomie, squib, waggish)

10. A raging passion that cooled

(risible, dalliance, antic)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false?

- _____ 1. You cannot trust a man with bonhomie.
- _____ 2. A waggish person would be likely to indulge in japery
- _____ 3. A dalliance is a brightly colored flower
- _____ 4. A roisterer would be found at a bacchanal
- _____ 5. A squib is a variety of an octopus that has ten tentacles
- _____ 6. Euphoria is a ride on cloud nine
- _____ 7. A guffaw is to a snake as antic is to serious
- _____ 8. The natural reaction to a risible event is to burst into tears.
- _____ 9. Waggish is a milder trait than its close synonym, roguish
- _____ 10. A regal personality is expected to regale his guests.

Lesson 37

History and Government

1. **anarchy**: the complete absence of government; political disorder and violence; disorder in any sphere of activity. The anarchist opposes all direct or coercive government and proposes the voluntary association of people as the mode of organized society.
2. **bourgeois**: typical of the social middle class; characterized by selfish concern for material comfort and for properly values. Bourgeois virtues are thriftiness and serious attitude toward life; its faults are a preoccupation with moneymaking and anxiety about respectability. It all depends on one's point of view.
3. **bureaucracy**: a system that rigidly adheres to the rules, forms, and routine. In American usage, the term is almost invariable derogatory unless the context establishes otherwise.
4. **demagogue**: a leader who obtains power by means of impassionate appeals to the emotions and prejudices of the populace. In ancient Greece, the demagogue was the leader who championed the cause of the common people.
5. **ethos**: the disposition, character, or attitude that distinguishes a particular group, epoch, or region.
6. **gerrymander**: to divide an area into voting districts to give unfair advantage to one party in an election. The word comes from a reference to Elbridge Gerry, governor of Massachusetts, whose party redistricted the state in 1812, combined with salamander; because the map of Essex County, Massachusetts, seemed to resemble this animal after the redistricting.
7. **imperialism**: the policy of extending the rule or authority of an empire or nation over countries, or of acquiring and holding colonies and dependencies.
8. **Machiavellian**: acting in accordance with the principles of government in which political expediency is placed above morality; subtly or unscrupulously cunning or deceptive. Nicolo Machiavelli in *The Prince* expounded the doctrine of political expediency.
9. **martial**: inclined or disposed to war; brave; warlike. The blood-red planet Mars was named after the Roman god of war.
10. **muckraker**: one who searches for and exposes real or alleged corruption and scandal. Muckrake, a rake for use on much or dung, was first used in the work of Lincoln Steffens and his contemporaries.

11. **partisan**: an adherent or supporter of a person, party, or cause; a member of an irregular troop engaged in harassing an enemy.
12. **reactionary**: a person who favors political conservatism or extreme rightism.
13. **schism**: a separation or division into factors. The term “The Great Schism” was used in connection with the Christian church to describe the split between the West and Eastern sects.
14. **suffrage**: the right to vote; a vote given in favor of a proposed measure or candidate
15. **totalitarian**: of or pertaining to a centralized government in which those in control grant neither recognition nor toleration to parties of differing opinions.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. The confederacy cotes to secede from the Union

(martial, gerrymander, schism)

2. Vote the party line all the way

(partisan, Machiavellian, reactionary)

3. Russia tries to expand its influence in the Middle East

(anarchy, imperialism, bureaucracy)

4. The Amish object to TV and other modern inventions and conveniences

(ethos, totalitarian, suffrage)

5. A spellbinding speaker

(demagogue, muckraker, bourgeois)

6. Red tape and needles duplication

(anarchy, reactionary, bureaucracy)

7. One form of investigative journalism

(bourgeois, muckraker, gerrymander)

8. Usually associated with Republicans

(Machiavellian, reactionary, imperialism)

9. Tries to crush autonomous institutions

(totalitarianism, ethos, martial)

10. The franchise

(partisan, schism, suffrage)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. Bourgeois manners tend to be different from the manners of those who have been born with “a silver spoon in their mouth.”

____ 2. To gerrymander is to vote on the basis of issue rather than party.

____ 3. Martial refers to a rank in the army.

____ 4. A Machiavellian attitude could lead to power but also to unpopularity.

____ 5. Anarchy is a form of government that is built upon bureaucracy.

____ 6. Anarchy is a form of government that favors gerrymandering.

____ 7. The ethos of a group is measured by its support of the government in power.

____ 8. Imperialism follows the totalitarian approach.

____ 9. “The Great Schism” ended the Papal monopoly over Christianity.

____ 10. For Machiavelli, the bottom line is, who wields the power?

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three.

- | | | | |
|------------------|-------------|-----------|----------|
| 1. anarchy | narcissism | terrorism | nihilism |
| 2. demagogue | instigator | pedant | agitator |
| 3. partisan | coherent | zealot | adherent |
| 4. schism | disjunction | fissure | quarry |
| 5. Machiavellian | deceptive | artistic | sinister |

Lesson 38

Legal Language

1. **abnegation**: giving up of rights; self-denial.
2. **abscond**: to run away and hide in order to escape the law.
3. **affidavit**: a written statement made on oath, usually before a notary public. In Medieval Latin, the verb *affidare* meant “he has made an oath.”
4. **altercation**: a quarrel; an angry or heated dispute. Other synonyms are spat and squabble. Wrangle suggests a noisy dispute.
5. **battery**: a pounding; illegal beating. A person who commits assault and battery inflicts physical harm upon a victim; an emplacement for artillery; an array of similar things to use together, as “a battery or achievement tests”; baseball term for the pitcher and catcher; in electricity, a cell or cells that produce an electric current.
6. **bequest**: something given by inheritance; a gift specified in a will. In Middle English, *bicewste* meant “a saying”
7. **cause celebre**: a celebrated law case, trial, or controversy
8. **caveat emptor**: let the buyer beware, one buys at his own risk. The implication is that the vendor is trying to sell inferior merchandise.
9. **codicil**: an addition to a will; an appendix or supplement. The Latin word *codex* means “tree trunk” or a “wooden tablet covered with wax for writing.”
10. **contiguous**: adjacent; touching.
11. **contraband**: goods forbidden by law to be exported. This word was first used in the sixteenth century to refer to illicit trade with Spanish colonies.
12. **contumacious**: insubordinate; disobedient. Its original Latin meaning was “to swell up.”
13. **disenfranchise**: to deprive of the rights of citizenship; to deprive of a privilege. This word is sometimes written as *disfranchise*.
14. **injunction**: a command or order; a court order stopping a person or group from carrying out a given action.
15. **jurisprudence**: the science or philosophy of law; a system of laws.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. When the financier could not be found, the scandal came to light.

(injunction, codicil, abscond)

2. A soldier is absent without leave

(contumacious, jurisprudence, disenfranchise)

3. The plight of the whales attracts world-wide attention

(cause celebre, caveat emptor, abnegation)

4. Hidden weapons are discovered by the airport's X-ray machine.

(contraband, contiguous, altercation)

5. Relatives gather to hear the reading of the will

(batter, affidavit, bequest)

6. Heavy artillery trained on the enemy

(altercation, battery, contraband)

7. A notarized statements

(bequest, injunction, affidavit)

8. Swore off smoking

(codicil, abnegation, disenfranchised)

9. What the law requires

(jurisprudence, cause celebre, affidavit)

10. Smuggles goods

(abscond, contraband, caveat emptor)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

- ____ 1. When a dog displays its contumacious spirit, obedience training is often prescribed.
- ____ 2. Merchants follow the policy of caveat emptor when competition is fierce.
- ____ 3. Out houses are contiguous, and I wish we were closer together
- ____ 4. An important codicil is like the tail that wagged the dog
- ____ 5. Following the altercation on the field, both players were ejected
- ____ 6. contiguous lines are necessarily parallel.
- ____ 7. A battery is a weapon used by the Romans to shatter protection walls.
- ____ 8. A thief might abscond to avoid prosecution
- ____ 9. An altercation is similar to a fracas
- ____ 10. A cause celebre is a reason for celebration

III. Fill in the Blank

Insert one of the new words in the proper space in each sentence below

- 1. The _____ specified that the heir marry within the faith
- 2. In discovering that the watch he had bought from the street vendor had no mechanism.
Fred learned the significance of _____.
- 3. Some people live by whim and fancy, others by a rigorous _____.
- 4. The charlatan's modus operandi was simple; ingratiate yourself with a rich widow,
many her, then _____ with the money.

5. To stop the flow of microchip technology out of the country, the government declared them _____.
6. The _____ For the crucial game was changed at the last minute
7. Ted wished he had remembered the warning _____, when he was offered the 80 percent discount for the “diamond” ring that turned out to be fake.
8. Pfc. Barton lost his one stripe when his _____ behavior was discovered.
9. The defense lawyer argued it was wrong to _____ his client because he had not renounced his former citizenship.
10. The judge threatened to issue a(n) _____ if the proposed strike plans were not withdrawn.

IV. What’s the Antonyms?

Which of the new words is most nearly opposite in meaning to the one provided?

- | | |
|--|-------|
| 1. compliant | _____ |
| 2. reconciliation | _____ |
| 3. permit | _____ |
| 4. self-indulgence | _____ |
| 5. empower | _____ |
| 6. distant | _____ |
| 7. legal trade | _____ |
| 8. an insignificant case | _____ |
| 9. money or property earned by one’s labor | _____ |
| 10. main section of a will | _____ |

Lesson 39

Philosophy and Logic

1. **aphorism**: a brief statement of principle; a tersely phrased statement of a truth or opinion
2. **dogma**: a system of principles or tenets as of a church; prescribed doctrine; an established opinion or belief. Dogmas, derived from the Greek *dokein*, “to seem good,” are sometimes put forth without adequate grounds and arrogantly or vehemently proclaimed.
3. **empirical**: guided by practical experience and not theoretical
4. **epistemology**: the branch of theology that is concerned with the ultimate or last things—such as death, judgment, heaven, and hell.
5. **eschatology**: an idea or opinion founded on mistaken logic or perception. There are several types of logical fallacies: the fallacy of accident, of composition, of decision, of the antecedent, and of the consequences.
6. **fallacy**: an idea or opinion founded on mistaken logic or perception. There are several types of logical fallacies: the fallacy of accident, of composition, of division, of the antecedent, and of the consequence.
7. **hedonism**: pursuit of or devotion to pleasure; the ethical doctrine that what is pleasant or has pleasant consequences is intrinsically good. In psychology, hedonism refers to the doctrine that behavior is motivated by desire for pleasure or the avoidance of pain.
8. **pragmatism**: the theory, developed by Charles S. Peirce and William James, that the meaning of a proposition or course of action lies in its observable consequences, and that the sum of these consequences constitutes its meaning; a method or tendency in the conduct of political affairs characterized by the rejection of theory and precedent and by the use of practical means and expedients. A pragmatic person is practical and active rather than contemplative. He may also tend to be meddlesome and officious.
9. **predestination**: the doctrine that God has foreordained whatever comes to pass, especially the salvation or damnation of individual souls.
10. **ratiocination**: the act of reasoning methodically or logically.
11. **sylogism**: in logic, a form of deductive reasoning consisting of a major premise (all men are foolish), a minor premise (Smith is a man), and a conclusion (therefore, Smith is foolish); a subtle or specious piece of reasoning. Opposed to syllogistic reasoning is inductive reasoning known as the scientific method, which reasons from a part to the whole, from the particular to the general, or from the individual to the universal.

12. **teleology**: the doctrine that final causes exist; design, purpose, or utility as an explanation of any natural phenomenon. In philosophy, teleology looks upon natural processes as determined by the design of a divine Providence rather than as purely mechanical determinism.

13. **tenet**: an opinion or doctrine held to be true.

14. **theosophy**: a system of philosophy or religion that proposes to establish direct, mystical contact with divine principles through contemplation or revelation. The doctrines of the modern Theosophical Societies incorporate elements of Buddhism and Brahmanism.

15. **utilitarian**: stressing the value of practical over aesthetic values. The theory of utilitarianism, proposed by Jeremy Bentham and John Stewart Mill, held that all moral, social, or political action should be directed toward achieving the greatest good for the greatest number of people.

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. How do we know what we know?

(eschatology, epistemology, pragmatism)

2. If A is B and B is C, then A is C

(fallacy, dogma, syllogism)

3. Sherlock Holmes is a prime example

(tenet, ratiocination, teleology)

4. Don't do it; it might hurt

(hedonism, aphorism, theosophy)

5. Daniel and Pearl forever

(empirical, utilitarian, predestination)

6. Use it or lose it

(utilitarian, aphorism, fallacy)

7. The quintessential principle that brooks no argument

(theosophy, teleology, dogma)

8. Beyond human comprehension

(eschatology, ratiocination, theosophy)

9. Respect for the old tried and true ways

(ratiocination, tenet, pragmatism)

10. Logic with a twist

(eschatology, teleology, syllogism)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false.

____ 1. A pragmatist and an empiricist are both more concerned with results than theories.

____ 2. Eschatology is deeply involved with daily rituals

____ 3. The explanation for the lion's mane, the elephant's trunk, the leopard's spots falls in the province of teleology.

____ 4. A tenet is one of the ten basic principles of faith.

____ 5. Aphorism is the belief that natural phenomena can be understood only by a study of original causes.

____ 6. Epistemology is the science of letter writing.

____ 7. The empirical approach relies on observation and experience to determine truth.

____ 8. An assumption based on erroneous premises will inevitably be a fallacy.

____ 9. Theosophists generally spend a great deal of time in contemplation.

____ 10. tenets are those who “dwell in the house of the Lord.”

III. Find the Imposter

Find and circle the one word on each line that is not related to the other three

- | | | | |
|----------------|--------------|-------------|----------------|
| 1. eschatology | teleology | utilitarian | predestination |
| 2. document | dogma | tenet | doctrine |
| 3. pragmatic | experiential | romantic | empirical |
| 4. laconic | aphoristic | pointed | conjectural |
| 5. hedonism | affliction | malaise | paroxysm |

Lesson 40

Beliefs and Religion

1. **agnostic**: a thinker who disclaims any knowledge of God. The agnostic does not deny God but denies the possibility of knowing him.
2. **apocalyptic**: pertaining to a revelation; foretelling imminent disaster and total destruction. Apocalypse refers to the last books of the New Testament.
3. **apocryphal**: of questionable authority and authenticity; false or counterfeit. The Apocrypha includes the 14 books of the Septuagint found in the Vulgate but considered uncanonical by the Protestant because they are not part of the Hebrew Scriptures.
4. **apostate**: one who forsakes his faith or principles
5. **apotheosis**: deification; an exalted or glorified ideal.
6. **benediction**: a blessing, an invocation of divine blessing, usually at the end of a religious service. A newly married man is called a benedict, suggesting that marriage brings to a bachelor many blessings.
7. **blasphemy**: any irreverent or impious act or utterance
8. **deist**: believer in the existence of God as the creator of the universe who after setting it in motion abandoned it, assumed no control over life, exerted no influence on natural phenomenon, and gave no supernatural revelation. Deism is a natural religion based on human reason and morality.
9. **infidel**: a person who does not believe in any religion; among Christians or Muslims, one who does not accept their particular beliefs. This word infidelity denotes unfaithfulness to moral or martial obligations.
10. **mantra**: a mystical formula of invocation or incantation in Hinduism and Buddhism. The word comes from mens, the Latin meaning “mind” and the ancient Sanskrit word for “sacred counsel” or “formula”
11. **ontology**: the branch of philosophy dealing with the nature of being
12. **pantheism**: the doctrine that the universe, conceived of as a whole, is God.
13. **sacrilegious**: disrespectful or irreverent toward anything regarded as sacred. The term is derived from the Latin sacrilegium, “one who steals sacred things,” which of course is one form of sacrilege.

14. **syncretism**: the attempt or tendency to combine or reconcile differing beliefs, as in philosophy or religion. It comes from the Greek syn (together) and kret (Cretan) and refers to the uniting of Cretan cities against a common enemy.

15. **theodicy**: a vindication of divine justice in the face of the existence of evil. *Theodicee* was the title of a work by Leibnitz in 1710. The word combines the Greek roots for “god” and “judgment”

Exercises

I. Which Word Comes to Mind?

In each of the following, read the statement, then circle the word that comes to mind.

1. In the Middle Ages this would have brought the harshest punishment

(ontology, blasphemy, apocryphal)

2. God and nature are synonymous

(benediction, pantheism, apocalyptic)

3. This person could be a Christian, Muslim, or Jew, depending on what you are

(infidel, mantra, apotheosis)

4. An attempt to explain why God permitted the rise of Hitlerism

(theodicy, apostate, sacrilegious)

5. If you can't beat them, join them

(agnostic, syncretism, deist)

6. The absolute best of its kind

(apotheosis, sacrilegious, apocryphal)

7. Doomsday is coming

(blasphemy, apocalyptic, ontology)

8. Belief that differing faiths can be reconciled

(agnostic, pantheist, syncretist)

9. A blessing

(mantra, benediction, blasphemy)

10. An unauthorized version

(sacrilegious, apocryphal, blasphemy)

II. True or False?

In the space provided, indicate whether each statement is true or false

- _____ 1. The apocryphal writings have been universally accepted as part of the Bible
- _____ 2. An apostate is one who has changed his religious beliefs.
- _____ 3. Pantheists emphasize the importance of religious services
- _____ 4. The sacrilegious person holds a place of honor in the community of believers
- _____ 5. The apocalyptic view is definitely pessimistic
- _____ 6. The agnostic is inclined to say, "Thank God for my blessings."
- _____ 7. The apostate finds solace in his mantra
- _____ 8. Ontology attempts to answer the question: What is reality?
- _____ 9. Sacrilegious and blasphemous behavior is typical of an apostate
- _____ 10. Mantras are part of the worship in Buddhism and Hinduism

III. Synonyms or Antonyms

Find and circle the two words on each line that are either synonyms or antonyms.

- | | | | |
|----------------|-------------|----------------|------------|
| 1. apostate | apocryphal | heretic | biblical |
| 2. blasphemous | apotheosis | degradation | occult |
| 3. infidel | mantra | religion | invocation |
| 4. canonical | apocryphal | apocalyptic | orthodox |
| 5. laity | benediction | denominational | anathema |

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